

# A Quantum Resource Theory of Transpose-Reciprocity Breaking from Non-Hermitian Propagators, with an Exact Witness on the Hatano–Nelson Skin-Effect Orbit

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We formulate a fixed-time quantum resource theory of transpose-reciprocity breaking for channels obtained from normalized non-Hermitian propagators through a canonical Julia unitary completion. Free channels are transpose-reciprocal; free superchannels are physical superchannels that preserve the bistochastic object class and commute with channel transpose, an axiomatic covariance choice rather than a hardware cost model. The channel asymmetry  $A_\diamond$ , equal to  $2p_{\text{succ}}^{\text{opt}} - 1$  for one-shot discrimination of a channel from its reciprocal transpose, and the generalized robustness are faithful monotones. On the two-site Hatano–Nelson orbit  $A_\diamond$  has a closed form that is strictly increasing in  $|g|$  under a common strict normalization, which gives a necessary condition for deterministic free conversion; the converse is not proved, and an ancilla-free unitary-congruence subclass is rigid. The support of the resource is normalization independent while its value is gauge dependent. An  $L$ -uniform short-time estimate gives a thermodynamic lower bound for uniform Hatano–Nelson chains. The resource detects transpose-reciprocity breaking, not non-Hermiticity or skin accumulation as such (it is also positive for Hermitian, gauge-trivial breaking); an exact biconditional with conventional NHSE holds only on model classes where the two are independently equivalent, such as the uniform Hatano–Nelson family. For coupled chains only the compressed-contraction Julia channel is treated; its relation to a many-body reduced channel is open.

## I. OPERATIONAL STARTING POINT: FIXED-TIME NHSE CHANNELS AS RESOURCES

A quantum resource theory is specified by an object class, a free subset, admissible free transformations, and the induced conversion preorder; resource monotones are nonincreasing under the free transformations [1, 2]. In channel resource theories, the primitive objects are quantum channels and the transformations can be represented by quantum superchannels [2, 3].

Our aim is to formulate a QRT in which transpose-reciprocity breaking is the primitive resource, with conventional NHSE arising as a physically motivated instance rather than as the object being axiomatized. The primitive resource object is a CPTP bistochastic channel at a fixed operational time  $t$ . A time-dependent non-Hermitian evolution gives a family of such objects, but the family is a derived trajectory rather than a new primitive process tensor or comb object.

**Remark 1** (Relation to time-reversal covariance and existing resource theories). *The condition  $\mathcal{N} = \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{CN}^\dagger\mathcal{C}$  of Remark 3 is a microreversibility (time-reversal) condition on the channel, of the same type as the quantum detailed-balance conditions [19–21]. The present theory can thus be read as a resource theory of violation of this time-reversal covariance, with an involution  $\text{rev}$  playing the role that a group action plays in resource theories of asymmetry [17]. The monotone  $A_\diamond$  is a channel-discrimination quantity of the type used in resource theories of asymmetric distinguishability [22]. We do not claim novelty for these general structures. What is specific to this paper is (i) the identification of the Julia completion of a normalized non-Hermitian propagator as the object, (ii) the reciprocity-covariant free superchannels on that object class, and (iii) the exact Hatano–Nelson*

*calibration and its thermodynamic lower bound.*

**Remark 2** (Physical status of the reciprocity-covariant free-operation choice). *We adopt covariance under channel transpose as the defining symmetry constraint on the free superchannel class. The motivation is that, in the fixed physical reciprocity frame, transpose exchanges the roles of forward and backward couplings, while transpose-reciprocal Hamiltonians describe devices with symmetric couplings in that frame, including reciprocal circuit elements, symmetric optical couplers, and Hermitian-coupling lattice realizations with on-site gain or loss.*

*The present paper should nevertheless distinguish two statements. First, covariance is an axiomatic resource-theoretic choice: it guarantees that free superchannels cannot create transpose-reciprocity breaking from a reciprocal channel and yields the monotonicity theorems below. Second, covariance alone is not a microscopic model of fabrication cost. In particular, the construction*

$$\Theta_\Gamma(\mathcal{N}) = \Gamma^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{N} \circ \Gamma \quad (1)$$

*of Proposition 15 allows an arbitrary bistochastic  $\Gamma$  from the stated finite-size object class as a processing primitive. We therefore do not interpret the present  $\mathfrak{D}_L$  class as a complete statement that every such implementation is physically resource-free in an engineering sense. Rather, it is the symmetry-covariant free-operation class of the QRT constructed here. A stricter hardware-level resource theory would require an additional, independently specified class of resource-neutral pre- and post-processing devices.*

**Remark 3** (Reciprocity as time-reversal invariance in the fixed frame). *Let  $\mathcal{C}(X) = X^*$  denote complex conjugation in the fixed basis. For a bistochastic channel  $\mathcal{N}$  with Kraus operators  $\{K_a\}$ , its Heisenberg-picture dual  $\mathcal{N}^\dagger(Y) =$*

$\sum_a K_a^\dagger Y K_a$  is again CPTP. Since  $(\sum_a K_a^\dagger X^* K_a)^* = \sum_a K_a^T X K_a^*$ , one has

$$\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{C} \circ \mathcal{N}^\dagger \circ \mathcal{C}. \quad (2)$$

Hence  $\mathcal{N} = \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}$  if and only if  $\mathcal{N}^\dagger = \mathcal{C} \mathcal{N} \mathcal{C}$ : the channel coincides with its own time reversal, the antiunitary being  $\mathcal{C}$  in the reciprocity frame. For the Julia unitary  $\tilde{U}_K$ , viewed as a scattering matrix between the physical and environmental ports,  $\tilde{U}_K^T = \tilde{U}_K$  is the Onsager–Casimir (Lorentz) reciprocity condition  $S = S^T$  [16]. The resource  $A_\diamond$  therefore quantifies the violation of this time-reversal invariance; it is not, by construction, a measure of non-Hermiticity (see Proposition 17). The covariance requirement on free superchannels remains an axiomatic choice, but it now has a concrete meaning: free transformations must commute with this specific time reversal.

A non-Hermitian Hamiltonian by itself does not define a CPTP map. We therefore normalize its propagator to a strict contraction and embed it into a canonical Julia unitary dilation. This completion is an operational representation of the normalized propagator; it is not a claim that every open-system realization of an NHSE is equivalent to a postselected non-Hermitian Hamiltonian, nor that the Julia dilation is the unique physical realization of the contraction.

**Definition 1** (Single-particle Hilbert space). *For a chain of length  $L$  with internal dimension  $M$ , let*

$$\mathcal{H}_L = \text{span} \{|n, \alpha\rangle : 1 \leq n \leq L, 1 \leq \alpha \leq M\}. \quad (3)$$

*The spatial basis is fixed once and for all. All reciprocity statements below refer to this basis. When the canonical Julia dilation is formed, the environmental copy is equipped with the corresponding copied spatial basis.*

Throughout,  $\|\cdot\|_\infty$  denotes the operator (spectral) norm.

**Definition 2** (Canonical dilation lattice). *For the canonical Julia completion define*

$$\tilde{\mathcal{H}}_L = \mathcal{H}_L \oplus \mathcal{H}_L^{\text{env}}, \quad \mathcal{H}_L^{\text{env}} \simeq \mathcal{H}_L, \quad (4)$$

and let

$$\tilde{P}_n = P_n \oplus P_n^{\text{env}} \quad (5)$$

*be the spatial projector onto the physical and environmental degrees of freedom associated with cell  $n$ . The fixed-time channel QRT below acts on  $\tilde{\mathcal{H}}_L$ .*

**Remark 4** (Reciprocity frame as operational data). *The transpose operation, and hence the distinction between reciprocal and transpose-reciprocity breaking channels, is defined relative to the fixed physical basis specified above. In particular, the resource is a property of the pair consisting of the channel and the chosen reciprocity frame, not of an abstract Hilbert-space operator under arbitrary unitary*

*changes of basis. A basis change is regarded as a mere relabeling only when it preserves the physical reciprocity datum used to define transpose. This qualification is essential for internal degrees of freedom, where a local unitary change of basis can alter the matrix condition  $H^T = H$  without changing the underlying laboratory device.*

**Definition 3** (Admissible normalized propagator). *Let  $H$  be a finite-dimensional non-Hermitian Hamiltonian and*

$$U_H(t) = e^{-iHt}. \quad (6)$$

*Let  $\mathcal{H}_{\text{adm}}$  be a Hamiltonian class closed under transpose,  $H \mapsto H^T$ , and define*

$$\kappa_*(t) := \sup_{H \in \mathcal{H}_{\text{adm}}} \|U_H(t)\|_\infty^2 < \infty \quad (7)$$

*for every operational time  $t$ . Since*

$$\|U_{H^T}(t)\|_\infty = \|U_H(t)\|_\infty, \quad (8)$$

*this normalization envelope is itself transpose invariant. Choose a strictly positive function  $\varepsilon(t) > 0$  and define the common admissible normalization*

$$\kappa_\varepsilon(t) = [1 + \varepsilon(t)] \kappa_*(t). \quad (9)$$

*Then*

$$K_{H,t} = \frac{U_H(t)}{\sqrt{\kappa_\varepsilon(t)}} \quad (10)$$

*is a strict contraction:*

$$K_{H,t}^\dagger K_{H,t} \leq \frac{1}{1 + \varepsilon(t)} \mathbb{1}. \quad (11)$$

*When short-time normalization information is needed, we assume  $\varepsilon(t) \rightarrow 0$  as  $t \rightarrow 0^+$ . If  $\|H\|_\infty \leq h_{\text{max}}$  throughout the admissible class, then*

$$\kappa_*(t) \leq e^{2h_{\text{max}}t}, \quad \kappa_\varepsilon(t) \leq [1 + \varepsilon(t)] e^{2h_{\text{max}}t}. \quad (12)$$

*Moreover,*

$$K_{H^T,t} = K_{H,t}^T. \quad (13)$$

The success branch associated with the normalized propagator is

$$\mathcal{E}_{H,t}^{\text{succ}}(\rho) = K_{H,t} \rho K_{H,t}^\dagger. \quad (14)$$

**Proposition 1** (Reciprocity-compatible Julia dilation). *For every contraction  $K$  on  $\mathcal{H}_L$ , define*

$$D_K = (\mathbb{1} - K^\dagger K)^{1/2}, \quad D_{K^\dagger} = (\mathbb{1} - K K^\dagger)^{1/2}, \quad (15)$$

*and let*

$$\tilde{\mathcal{H}}_L = \mathcal{H}_L \oplus \mathcal{H}_L^{\text{env}}. \quad (16)$$

The Julia operator

$$\tilde{U}_K = \begin{pmatrix} K & D_{K^\dagger} \\ D_K & -K^\dagger \end{pmatrix} \quad (17)$$

is unitary. If  $K^T = K$ , then

$$\tilde{U}_K^T = \tilde{U}_K. \quad (18)$$

Consequently

$$\tilde{\mathcal{E}}_K(X) = \tilde{U}_K X \tilde{U}_K^\dagger \quad (19)$$

is CPTP, unital, and reciprocal whenever  $K^T = K$ .

*Proof.* The Julia operator is unitary for every contraction. The standard defect identities

$$D_{K^\dagger} K = K D_K, \quad D_K K^\dagger = K D_{K^\dagger} \quad (20)$$

together with

$$D_K^2 = \mathbb{1} - K^\dagger K, \quad D_{K^\dagger}^2 = \mathbb{1} - K K^\dagger \quad (21)$$

give

$$\tilde{U}_K^\dagger \tilde{U}_K = \tilde{U}_K \tilde{U}_K^\dagger = \mathbb{1}. \quad (22)$$

If  $K^T = K$ , then

$$D_K^T = D_{K^\dagger}, \quad D_{K^\dagger}^T = D_K, \quad (23)$$

by functional calculus and  $K^* = K^\dagger$  in this case. Hence the Julia block matrix is symmetric.  $\square$

**Corollary 1** (General transpose covariance of the Julia dilation). *For every contraction  $K$ ,*

$$\tilde{U}_K^T = \tilde{U}_{K^T}, \quad \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_K^{\text{rev}} = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{K^T}. \quad (24)$$

Hence, for the transpose-closed scalar normalization of Definition 3,

$$\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{N}_{H^T,t}. \quad (25)$$

*Proof.* For a general matrix  $K$ , functional calculus gives the exact identities

$$D_K^T = D_{K^*}, \quad D_{K^\dagger}^T = D_{K^T}. \quad (26)$$

Therefore

$$\tilde{U}_K^T = \begin{pmatrix} K^T & D_{K^*} \\ D_{K^T} & -K^* \end{pmatrix} = \tilde{U}_{K^T}, \quad (27)$$

which proves the first identity. For a unitary channel, channel transpose is generated by the transposed implementing unitary, proving the second. The final statement follows from  $K_{H^T,t} = K_{H,t}^T$ .  $\square$

**Remark 5** (Canonical representation choice). *The map*

$$K \mapsto \tilde{U}_K \mapsto \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_K \quad (28)$$

*is fixed as the canonical representation convention of the present QRT. The results below therefore concern the chosen Julia-completed channel representative. They do not assert that all Stinespring dilations of the same contraction, or all physical open-system realizations of the same non-Hermitian evolution, are resource-equivalent.*

**Lemma 1** (Quasi-locality of the Julia dilation). *Suppose  $H$  is uniformly bounded and finite range in one dimension, and the normalization is chosen so that  $\|K_{H,t}\|_\infty \leq q_t < 1$  uniformly in system size. Then, at each fixed finite time,  $U_H(t)$ ,  $K_{H,t}$ ,  $D_{K_{H,t}}$ ,  $D_{K_{H,t}^\dagger}$ , and  $\tilde{U}_{K_{H,t}}$  are exponentially quasi-local. In particular, there exist  $C_t, \mu_t > 0$ , independent of  $L$ , such that*

$$\|\tilde{P}_n A \tilde{P}_m\| \leq C_t e^{-\mu_t |n-m|} \quad (29)$$

for each operator  $A$  in the list.

*Proof.* If  $H$  has range  $R$ , then  $H^r$  has range at most  $rR$ , and

$$P_n U_H(t) P_m = \sum_{r \geq |n-m|/R} \frac{(-it)^r}{r!} P_n H^r P_m. \quad (30)$$

The resulting Poisson tail is exponentially small at fixed  $t$ . The same is true of  $K_{H,t}$  and  $K_{H,t}^\dagger K_{H,t}$ . Since  $\|K_{H,t}^\dagger K_{H,t}\|_\infty \leq q_t^2 < 1$ , the binomial series

$$(\mathbb{1} - X)^{1/2} = \sum_{r=0}^{\infty} c_r X^r, \quad X = K_{H,t}^\dagger K_{H,t}, \quad (31)$$

converges absolutely in operator norm. Operator-norm convergence alone does not control off-diagonal decay, because the constants of  $X^r$  accumulate, so we argue in a weighted norm. Let  $\hat{x}|n, \alpha\rangle = n|n, \alpha\rangle$  and  $A_{\sigma\mu} := e^{\sigma\mu\hat{x}} A e^{-\sigma\mu\hat{x}}$  for  $\sigma = \pm 1$ . Then

$$\|P_n A P_m\|_\infty \leq e^{-\sigma\mu(n-m)} \|A_{\sigma\mu}\|_\infty. \quad (\star)$$

*Step 1.* Write  $H = \sum_{|r| \leq R} H^{(r)}$  with displacement bands  $H^{(r)}$ ,  $\|H^{(r)}\|_\infty \leq h$  (Fourier average of  $e^{i\theta\hat{x}} H e^{-i\theta\hat{x}}$ ). Then  $H_{\sigma\mu} - H = \sum_r (e^{\sigma\mu r} - 1) H^{(r)}$ , so  $\|H_{\sigma\mu} - H\|_\infty \leq \delta(\mu) := (2R+1)h(e^{\mu R} - 1)$ . Duhamel's formula gives  $\|U_{\sigma\mu} - U\|_\infty \leq t\delta(\mu)e^{(h+\delta(\mu))t}$ , hence  $\|K_{\sigma\mu}\|_\infty \leq q_t + \varepsilon_t(\mu)$  with  $\varepsilon_t(\mu) = t\delta(\mu)e^{(h+\delta(\mu))t}/\sqrt{\kappa} \rightarrow 0$  as  $\mu \rightarrow 0$ , uniformly in  $L$ . Since  $(K^\dagger)_{\sigma\mu} = (K_{-\sigma\mu})^\dagger$ , the same bound holds for  $K^\dagger$ .

*Step 2.*  $X_{\sigma\mu} = (K^\dagger)_{\sigma\mu} K_{\sigma\mu}$  obeys  $\|X_{\sigma\mu}\|_\infty \leq \xi := (q_t + \varepsilon_t(\mu))^2$ . Choose  $\mu_t > 0$  with  $\xi < 1$ . Conjugation by  $e^{\sigma\mu\hat{x}}$  is an algebra homomorphism, so  $[(\mathbb{1} - X)^{1/2}]_{\sigma\mu} = \sum_r c_r (X_{\sigma\mu})^r$ , and since  $c_0 = 1$ ,  $c_r < 0$  for  $r \geq 1$  and  $\sum_{r \geq 1} |c_r| \xi^r = 1 - \sqrt{1 - \xi} \leq 1$ , we get  $\|(D_K)_{\sigma\mu}\|_\infty \leq 2$ .

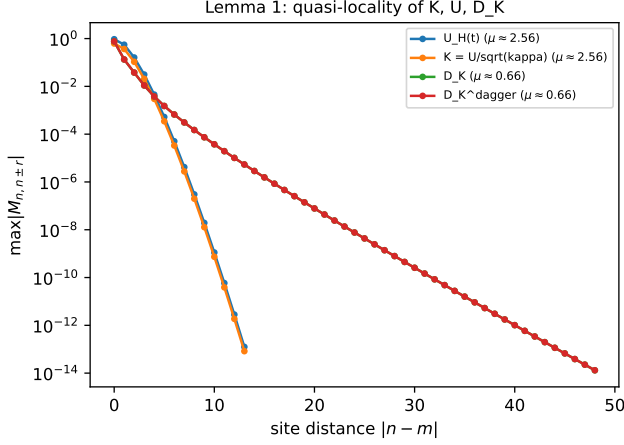


FIG. 1. Numerical consistency check of Lemma 1 for a finite-range, uniformly bounded Hamiltonian at fixed  $L$  and fixed operational time  $t$ . The propagator  $U_H(t)$  and the normalized contraction  $K = U_H(t)/\sqrt{\kappa}$  give the same fitted rate ( $\mu \approx 2.56$ ), as expected from the scalar relation between them. For the defect operators, the fit on  $r \in [2, 25]$  gives  $\mu \approx 0.66$ , while a fit over the full available range  $r \in [2, 48]$  gives approximately  $\mu \approx 0.59$ . The fit-window dependence is therefore non-negligible, and no precision exponent is claimed. The robust numerical observation is qualitative exponential decay of the defect operators over the tested range, with visibly slower decay and greater fit sensitivity than  $K$ . The  $U_H(t)/K$  curves are fit by least squares on  $r \in [2, 13]$  before reaching double-precision noise.

The same holds for  $D_{K^\dagger}$  (with  $KK^\dagger$ ) and, from Step 1, for  $K$  and  $U_H(t)$ . Combining with  $(\star)$  and the block form of  $\tilde{U}_K$  gives the bound in the statement of the lemma with  $\mu = \mu_t$  and an  $L$ -independent constant. The admissible rate  $\mu_t$  is set by  $q_t$  and  $\delta(\mu)$ , not by the factorial tail of  $U_H(t)$ ; this explains why the defect operators decay more slowly than  $K$  in Fig. 1. Moreover  $U_H(t)$  itself decays faster than any exponential (Poisson tail), so the quoted  $\mu \approx 2.56$  is a window-dependent local slope, not a rate.  $\square$

**Remark 6.** *Quasi-locality, rather than strict finite range, is the natural class because the defect operators are generally not finite range even when  $K$  is.*

**Definition 4** (Fixed-time resource channel). *For Hamiltonian  $H$  and fixed operational time  $t$ , define the primitive resource object*

$$\boxed{\mathcal{N}_{H,t} := \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{K_{H,t}}.} \quad (32)$$

*This definition uses the canonical Julia-completed representative fixed above. The resource is therefore defined relative to the chosen normalization convention and canonical representation choice.*

**Definition 5** (Trajectory-derived channel resource). *For a time window  $\mathcal{T}$ , define the derived trajectory*

$$\boxed{\mathfrak{N}_H : \mathcal{T} \rightarrow \text{Obj}, \quad t \mapsto \mathcal{N}_{H,t}.} \quad (33)$$

*This map is not treated as a primitive process tensor or quantum comb.*

**Definition 6** (Physical-input channel asymmetry). *Let  $\mathcal{N} = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_K$  be the Julia channel and  $R$  an arbitrary reference system with  $\dim R \geq \dim \mathcal{H}_L$ . Define*

$$A_\diamond^{\text{phys}}(\mathcal{N}) = \sup_{\rho \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{H}_L \otimes R)} \frac{1}{2} \|(\mathcal{N} \otimes \text{id}_R)(\rho) - (\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} \otimes \text{id}_R)(\rho)\|_1, \quad (34)$$

*where inputs are supported on the physical block  $\mathcal{H}_L \subset \tilde{\mathcal{H}}_L$  only. The environmental block and coherences between the two blocks are excluded, because the environmental port of the canonical dilation is not an operationally preparable input.*

**Proposition 2** (Physical-input asymmetry). *Let  $K$  be a strict contraction,  $\tilde{U} = \tilde{U}_K$ ,  $W = \tilde{U}^\dagger \tilde{U}^T$ , and  $W_{11} = K^\dagger K^T + D_K D_{K^T}$  its physical diagonal block. Then:*

1.  $A_\diamond^{\text{phys}} = \sqrt{1 - \nu_{\text{ph}}^2}$  with  $\nu_{\text{ph}} = \min\{|z| : z \in \mathcal{W}(W_{11})\}$ ,  $\mathcal{W}$  the numerical range;
2.  $A_\diamond^{\text{phys}} \leq A_\diamond$ ;
3.  $A_\diamond^{\text{phys}} \geq \frac{1}{2} \max_m \sum_n ||K(n, m)|^2 - |K(m, n)|^2|$ , i.e. the transition-amplitude bound of Proposition 28 already holds for physical inputs;
4.  $A_\diamond^{\text{phys}} = 0 \iff A_\diamond = 0 \iff K = K^T$ .

*Proof.* (1) For pure  $\psi \in \mathcal{H}_L \otimes R$  the two outputs are the pure states  $(\tilde{U} \otimes \mathbb{1})\psi$  and  $(\tilde{U}^T \otimes \mathbb{1})\psi$ , whose trace distance is  $\sqrt{1 - |\langle \psi | W \otimes \mathbb{1} | \psi \rangle|^2}$ , and  $\langle \psi | W \otimes \mathbb{1} | \psi \rangle = \langle \psi | W_{11} \otimes \mathbb{1} | \psi \rangle$ . Mixed inputs do not increase the distance by convexity. Since  $\dim R \geq \dim \mathcal{H}_L$ , the reduced states on  $\mathcal{H}_L$  exhaust all density operators, and the resulting set is  $\mathcal{W}(W_{11})$  by the Toeplitz–Hausdorff theorem. The expression for  $W_{11}$  follows from block multiplication and  $D_{K^\dagger}^T = D_{K^T}$ .

(2)  $\mathcal{W}(W_{11}) \subseteq \mathcal{W}(W)$ , so  $\nu_{\text{ph}} \geq \nu(W)$ ; compare with the exact discrimination formula [11] used in Theorem 5.

(3) Take the input  $|m\rangle$ . The outputs are  $\tilde{U}|m\rangle$  and  $\tilde{U}^T|m\rangle$ ; measuring the site basis of  $\tilde{\mathcal{H}}_L$  gives physical-block probabilities  $|K(n, m)|^2$  and  $|\tilde{U}_{mn}|^2 = |K(m, n)|^2$ . The trace distance is at least the total-variation distance, which is at least half the sum of the physical-block differences.

(4) If  $K = K^T$  then  $\tilde{U}^T = \tilde{U}$  and all three quantities vanish. If  $A_\diamond^{\text{phys}} = 0$  then  $|\langle \psi | W_{11} | \psi \rangle| = 1$  for every unit  $\psi$ ; since  $W_{11}$  is a contraction, every  $\psi$  is an eigenvector with a unimodular eigenvalue, hence  $W_{11} = e^{i\varphi} \mathbb{1}$ . Unitarity of  $W$  forces  $W_{12} = W_{21} = 0$ , so the first block column of  $\tilde{U}^T = \tilde{U}W$  gives  $K^T = e^{i\varphi} K$  and  $D_{K^\dagger}^T = e^{i\varphi} D_K$ .

If  $K \neq 0$ ,  $K^T = e^{i\varphi} K$  implies  $e^{2i\varphi} = 1$ . The case  $e^{i\varphi} = -1$  would give  $D_{K^T} = -D_K$ ; but  $D_{K^T} = D_K$  because  $D$  depends only on  $K^\dagger K$  and  $K^T = -K$ , so  $D_K = 0$ , contradicting strictness. Hence  $\varphi = 0$  and  $K = K^T$ . The case  $K = 0$  is trivial.  $\square$

**Proposition 3** (Support is independent of the unitary dilation). *Let  $V$  be any unitary on  $\mathcal{H}_L \oplus \mathcal{E}$  ( $\mathcal{E}$  arbitrary) whose physical block is  $V_{11} = K$ . If the unitary channel  $V \cdot V^\dagger$  equals its own transpose, then  $K^T = \pm K$ . In particular, if  $K^T \neq \pm K$ , then every unitary dilation of  $K$  is non-reciprocal.*

*Proof.* Equality of unitary channels gives  $V^T = e^{i\varphi} V$ . Taking the physical block,  $K^T = e^{i\varphi} K$ , hence  $K = e^{2i\varphi} K$ , so either  $K = 0$  or  $e^{i\varphi} = \pm 1$ .  $\square$

**Corollary 2** (Physical-input asymmetry on the two-site calibration orbit). *For the two-site Hatano–Nelson calibration of Sec. VII in the strict regime,  $W_{11} = c(g) \mathbb{1}$  with  $c(g)$  as in Theorem 5. Consequently*

$$A_\diamond^{\text{phys}}(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}) = A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}) = \sqrt{1 - c(g)^2}. \quad (35)$$

The ordering of Corollary 4 therefore holds for physical inputs as well.

*Proof.* With  $K_g = -iu \begin{pmatrix} 0 & e^g \\ e^{-g} & 0 \end{pmatrix}$  one has  $K_g^\dagger K_g^T = u^2 \mathbb{1}$ , and  $D_{K_g} = \text{diag}(a, b)$ ,  $D_{K_g^T} = \text{diag}(b, a)$  (the latter is  $D_{K_{-g}}$ ), so  $D_{K_g} D_{K_g^T} = ab \mathbb{1}$ . Hence  $W_{11} = (u^2 + ab) \mathbb{1} = c(g) \mathbb{1}$ , its numerical range is the single point  $c(g)$ , and Proposition 2(1) gives  $A_\diamond^{\text{phys}} = \sqrt{1 - c(g)^2}$ , which is the value of Theorem 5.  $\square$

**Remark 7** (What is and is not claimed). *Propositions 2 and 3 show that the support of the resource ( $K \neq K^T$ ) does not depend on the inaccessible environmental inputs or on the choice of unitary dilation. The value of  $A_\diamond$  does depend on both. We do not claim that  $A_\diamond^{\text{phys}}$  is monotone under  $\mathfrak{D}_L$ : a free superchannel may route inputs into the environmental block, so monotonicity is proved only for  $A_\diamond$  and  $R_{\text{rob}}$ . Whether a physical-input monotone exists is open.*

**Lemma 2** (Conditional spatial transition probabilities). *For a localized physical input  $|m\rangle$  and conditioning on successful return to the physical sector,*

$$P_t(n|m) = \frac{|U_H(t)_{nm}|^2}{\sum_r |U_H(t)_{rm}|^2}. \quad (36)$$

*Proof.* The physical success probability at site  $n$  is proportional to  $|K_{H,t}(n, m)|^2$ . The scalar normalization cancels upon conditioning.  $\square$

## II. RECIPROCITY, LOCALITY, FREE CHANNELS, AND FREE SUPERCHANNELS

**Definition 7** (Finite-size exponential compatibility class). *For fixed  $L$ , let  $\mathfrak{Q}_{\text{exp},L}$  be the set of channels  $\mathcal{N}_L$  on  $\tilde{\mathcal{H}}_L$  for which there exist constants  $C, \mu > 0$  and a Kraus representation*

$$\mathcal{N}_L(X) = \sum_a K_{a,L} X K_{a,L}^\dagger \quad (37)$$

*satisfying*

$$\sum_a \left\| \tilde{P}_n K_{a,L} \tilde{P}_m \right\|^2 \leq C^2 e^{-2\mu|n-m|} \quad (38)$$

*for all sites  $n, m$ . At fixed  $L$ , the constants may depend on the channel and on  $L$ .*

*Because the Hilbert space is finite dimensional, every finite-dimensional channel belongs to  $\mathfrak{Q}_{\text{exp},L}$ . Indeed, for any fixed  $\mu > 0$  and any finite Kraus representation one may choose*

$$C = \max_{n,m} e^{\mu|n-m|} \left( \sum_a \left\| \tilde{P}_n K_{a,L} \tilde{P}_m \right\|^2 \right)^{1/2}, \quad (39)$$

*which is finite. Thus the fixed- $L$  condition is retained only as a compatibility notation for the thermodynamic locality structure introduced below.*

**Definition 8** (Bistochastic channel class). *For finite  $L$ ,*

$$\text{Chan}_L^{\text{bi}} = \left\{ \mathcal{N} \in \text{Chan}(\tilde{\mathcal{H}}_L) : \mathcal{N}(\mathbb{1}) = \mathbb{1} \right\}. \quad (40)$$

*Because all maps in  $\text{Chan}_L^{\text{bi}}$  are CPTP by definition, this is precisely the finite-dimensional class of CPTP bistochastic channels.*

**Definition 9** (Finite-size object class). *For each finite  $L$ , define*

$$\text{Obj}_L = \text{Chan}_L^{\text{bi}}. \quad (41)$$

*Equivalently, this is the diamond-norm closure of  $\mathfrak{Q}_{\text{exp},L} \cap \text{Chan}_L^{\text{bi}}$ , since  $\mathfrak{Q}_{\text{exp},L}$  already contains all finite-dimensional channels at fixed  $L$ . Thermodynamic statements refer to sequences drawn from these fixed-size classes with additional  $L$ -uniform locality bounds.*

**Remark 8** (Where locality becomes nontrivial). *At fixed finite  $L$ , the primitive QRT is therefore a symmetry/covariance resource theory on the bistochastic channel class; the exponential locality condition is not a substantive restriction. All nontrivial locality content enters through the  $L$ -uniform family definitions and locality certificates used in the thermodynamic layer. This separation is deliberate and will be used throughout.*

**Definition 10** (Thermodynamic object family). A sequence  $\{\mathcal{N}_L\}_{L \geq 1}$  is a thermodynamically admissible object family if, for every compact operational time interval  $\mathcal{T}_0$ , there are constants  $C_{\mathcal{T}_0}, \mu_{\mathcal{T}_0} > 0$  independent of  $L$  and  $t \in \mathcal{T}_0$  and Kraus representations of  $\mathcal{N}_{L,t}$  such that

$$\sum_a \left\| \tilde{P}_n K_{a,L,t} \tilde{P}_m \right\|^2 \leq C_{\mathcal{T}_0}^2 e^{-2\mu_{\mathcal{T}_0}|n-m|} \quad (42)$$

for all  $n, m$ , while  $\mathcal{N}_{L,t} \in \text{Obj}_L$  for every  $L, t$ .

**Definition 11** (Channel transpose). For  $\mathcal{N} \in \text{Chan}_L^{\text{bi}}$  with Kraus operators  $\{K_a\}$  in the fixed spatial and environmental basis, define

$$\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}(X) = \sum_a K_a^T X K_a^*. \quad (43)$$

**Lemma 3** (Basic properties of channel transpose). For every  $\mathcal{N} \in \text{Chan}_L^{\text{bi}}$ :

1.  $\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} \in \text{Chan}_L^{\text{bi}}$ ;
2.  $(\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}})^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{N}$ ;
3. if  $\mathcal{U}(X) = UXU^\dagger$ , then  $\mathcal{U}^{\text{rev}}(X) = U^T X U^*$ ;
4. the definition is independent of the chosen Kraus representation;
5. transpose preserves  $\text{Obj}_L$ ;
6. the map  $\mathcal{N} \mapsto \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}$  is linear and continuous in finite dimension.

*Proof.* Set  $L_a = K_a^T$ . Complete positivity is immediate. Trace preservation follows from bistochasticity:

$$\sum_a L_a^\dagger L_a = \sum_a K_a^* K_a^T = \left( \sum_a K_a K_a^\dagger \right)^T = \mathbb{1}. \quad (44)$$

Unitality follows from the original trace-preserving condition:

$$\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}(\mathbb{1}) = \sum_a K_a^T K_a^* = \left( \sum_a K_a^\dagger K_a \right)^T = \mathbb{1}. \quad (45)$$

Double transpose returns the original Kraus operators. If  $L_b = \sum_a u_{ba} K_a$  is another Kraus representation, then  $L_b^T = \sum_a u_{ba} K_a^T$  and

$$\sum_b L_b^T X L_b^* = \sum_{a,a'} \left( \sum_b u_{ba} u_{ba'}^* \right) K_a^T X K_{a'}^* = \sum_a K_a^T X K_a^*, \quad (46)$$

so the channel is representation independent.

Finally,

$$\tilde{P}_n K_a^T \tilde{P}_m = (\tilde{P}_m K_a \tilde{P}_n)^T, \quad (47)$$

so the same locality bound holds after exchanging the two sites; diamond-norm closure is preserved by continuity. Linearity and continuity are immediate in finite dimension because  $\text{rev}$  is a fixed linear involution on the finite-dimensional vector space of superoperators.  $\square$

**Remark 9** (Transpose is not assumed to be a diamond isometry). The channel-transpose involution is not used anywhere below as a diamond-norm isometry. In particular, in general one cannot assert

$$\|\mathcal{A}^{\text{rev}} - \mathcal{B}^{\text{rev}}\|_\diamond = \|\mathcal{A} - \mathcal{B}\|_\diamond. \quad (48)$$

Whenever continuity of  $\text{rev}$  is needed, it is stated either as a separate finite-dimensional continuity bound or directly as an assumption on both a channel and its transpose.

**Lemma 4** (Convexity and anti-homomorphism). For  $\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B} \in \text{Chan}_L^{\text{bi}}$  and  $\alpha + \beta = 1$ ,

$$(\alpha\mathcal{A} + \beta\mathcal{B})^{\text{rev}} = \alpha\mathcal{A}^{\text{rev}} + \beta\mathcal{B}^{\text{rev}}, \quad (49)$$

while

$$(\mathcal{A} \circ \mathcal{B})^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{B}^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{A}^{\text{rev}}. \quad (50)$$

Also,

$$(\mathcal{N} \otimes \mathbb{1}_E)^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} \otimes \mathbb{1}_E, \quad \left( \bigotimes_k \mathcal{N}_k \right)^{\text{rev}} = \bigotimes_k \mathcal{N}_k^{\text{rev}}. \quad (51)$$

*Proof.* For composition, the Kraus operators are  $A_a B_b$ , and

$$(A_a B_b)^T = B_b^T A_a^T. \quad (52)$$

The tensor identities follow from tensor-product Kraus representations.  $\square$

**Remark 10** (Why covariance is imposed on the complete superchannel). Because channel transpose reverses composition order, a reciprocal pre-processing map and a reciprocal post-processing map do not by themselves imply covariance. The correct free-operation condition is therefore

$$\Theta(\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}) = [\Theta(\mathcal{N})]^{\text{rev}} \quad (53)$$

for the complete superchannel. This is stronger and better typed than imposing a separate reciprocity condition on the individual pre- and post-processing components.

**Remark 11** (Covariance is a genuine restriction, not a vacuous one). It is worth exhibiting explicitly that the composite covariance condition rules out superchannels built from individually non-reciprocal, and otherwise unremarkable, processing maps. Take  $\Gamma_{\text{pre}} = \Gamma_{\text{post}} = \mathcal{V}$  for a fixed unitary conjugation  $\mathcal{V}(X) = V X V^\dagger$  with  $V$  an arbitrary (non-symmetric) unitary, and no ancilla. Then

$$\Theta(\mathcal{N}) = \mathcal{V} \circ \mathcal{N} \circ \mathcal{V}, \quad [\Theta(\mathcal{N})]^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{V}^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{V}^{\text{rev}} \quad (54)$$

by Lemma 4, while

$$\Theta(\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}) = \mathcal{V} \circ \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{V}. \quad (55)$$

Covariance for all  $\mathcal{N}$  requires  $\mathcal{V} \circ \mathcal{M} \circ \mathcal{V} = \mathcal{V}^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{M} \circ \mathcal{V}^{\text{rev}}$  for all  $\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}$  in the object class. Taking  $\mathcal{M}$  to be unitary channels with implementing unitary  $W$  ranging over a sufficiently rich set (e.g. all local unitaries), this requires  $VWV \propto V^T W V^T$  for all such  $W$ , and hence  $A := (V^T)^{-1}V \propto \mathbb{1}$ , i.e.  $V^T \propto V$ . Thus for  $V$  with  $V^T \not\propto V$  the superchannel  $\mathcal{N} \mapsto \mathcal{V} \circ \mathcal{N} \circ \mathcal{V}$  is not free, even though  $\mathcal{V}$  is an innocuous unitary; conversely, if  $V^T \propto V$  then  $\mathcal{V}^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{V}$  and covariance holds. The paired choice  $\Gamma_{\text{post}} = \Gamma_{\text{pre}}^{\text{rev}}$  of Proposition 15 restores covariance for arbitrary  $\Gamma_{\text{pre}}$ . The covariance constraint is therefore a nontrivial selection rule on how pre- and post-processing must be correlated, not a condition satisfied by generic physical processing.

**Definition 12** (Free channel set). For each finite  $L$ , define

$$\mathfrak{F}_L = \{\mathcal{N} \in \text{Obj}_L : \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{N}\}. \quad (56)$$

Thus the free channels are precisely the reciprocal subset of the allowed quasi-local bistochastic channels.

**Proposition 4** (Hamiltonian reciprocity implies channel reciprocity). If  $H^T = H$ , then

$$U_H(t)^T = U_H(t), \quad K_{H,t}^T = K_{H,t}, \quad (57)$$

and hence

$$\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{N}_{H,t}. \quad (58)$$

*Proof.* Transpose commutes with the exponential:

$$U_H(t)^T = e^{-iH^T t} = e^{-iHt} = U_H(t), \quad (59)$$

and the normalization is a transpose-invariant positive scalar. Proposition 1 then gives reciprocity.  $\square$

### A. Free superchannels and a thermodynamic locality certificate

**Definition 13** (Physical finite-size free superchannel). A deterministic quantum superchannel has the physical realization

$$\Theta(\mathcal{N}) = \Gamma_{\text{post}} \circ (\mathcal{N} \otimes \mathbb{1}_E) \circ \Gamma_{\text{pre}}, \quad (60)$$

where  $\Gamma_{\text{pre}}, \Gamma_{\text{post}}$  are CPTP maps and  $E$  is an auxiliary memory system [3].

A finite-size superchannel is free if:

1. it is physically realizable;
2. it preserves the object class,

$$\Theta(\text{Obj}_L) \subseteq \text{Obj}_L; \quad (61)$$

3. it is reciprocity-covariant,

$$\Theta(\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}) = [\Theta(\mathcal{N})]^{\text{rev}} \quad \forall \mathcal{N} \in \text{Obj}_L. \quad (62)$$

The covariance and object-preservation requirements are conditions on the complete superchannel, not on the individual pre- and post-processing maps separately. We denote this finite-size class by  $\mathfrak{D}_L$ .

**Definition 14** (Quasi-local CPTP preprocessing/postprocessing certificate). Let  $\Gamma_L$  be a CPTP map whose input and output lattices carry the fixed spatial basis. We say that  $\Gamma_L$  is  $(C_\Gamma, \mu_\Gamma)$  quasi-local in the Heisenberg sense if, for every finite interval  $V$ , every  $r \geq 0$ , and every observable  $O_V$  supported on  $V$ , there exists an observable  $O_{V(+r)}$  supported on the  $r$ -neighborhood of  $V$  such that

$$\left\| \Gamma_L^\dagger(O_V) - O_{V(+r)} \right\|_\infty \leq C_\Gamma |V| e^{-\mu_\Gamma r} \|O_V\|_\infty. \quad (63)$$

A finite-depth bounded-range circuit channel is a special case, with an error that vanishes exactly beyond a finite light cone.

**Definition 15** (Locality certificate for a superchannel family). A thermodynamic family  $\{\Theta_{L,t}\}_{L \geq 1, t \in \mathcal{T}_0}$  admits a locality certificate on a compact operational time interval  $\mathcal{T}_0$  if there are ancillary memories  $E_L$  decomposed into spatial cells with uniformly bounded local dimension, and physical realizations

$$\Theta_{L,t}(\mathcal{N}) = \Gamma_{\text{post},L,t} \circ (\mathcal{N} \otimes \mathbb{1}_{E_L}) \circ \Gamma_{\text{pre},L,t}, \quad (64)$$

for which both  $\Gamma_{\text{pre},L,t}$  and  $\Gamma_{\text{post},L,t}$  satisfy the Heisenberg quasi-locality condition in Definition 14 with constants bounded independently of  $L$  and  $t \in \mathcal{T}_0$ . This certificate is required only at the family level; no covariance is imposed on either component separately.

A time-independent superchannel family is included as the special case  $\Theta_{L,t} = \Theta_L$ .

**Definition 16** (Thermodynamic free-superchannel family). A collection

$$\{\Theta_{L,t}\}_{L \geq 1, t \in \mathcal{T}_0} \quad (65)$$

is a thermodynamically free superchannel family on  $\mathcal{T}_0$  if each  $\Theta_{L,t} \in \mathfrak{D}_L$  and the family admits a locality certificate with constants uniform in  $L$  and  $t \in \mathcal{T}_0$ . We denote the class of such families by  $\mathfrak{D}_\infty$ .

**Remark 12** (Non-vacuous thermodynamic locality). The family-level definition is the actual thermodynamic locality condition used in all thermodynamic monotonicity statements. Thus an arbitrary finite-size global channel is not automatically promoted to a thermodynamically free transformation merely because it happens to belong to  $\mathfrak{D}_L$  at every fixed  $L$ .

**Definition 17** (Fixed-time conversion preorder). For  $\mathcal{N}, \mathcal{M} \in \text{Obj}_L$ , write

$$\mathcal{N} \succeq_{\mathfrak{D}} \mathcal{M} \quad (66)$$

if there exists a finite-size free superchannel  $\Theta \in \mathfrak{D}_L$  such that  $\Theta(\mathcal{N}) = \mathcal{M}$ .

**Proposition 5** (Basic closure properties of the free transformations). *The identity superchannel is free, the composition of two free superchannels is free, and every free superchannel preserves the free set:*

$$\boxed{\mathcal{N} \in \mathfrak{F}_L \implies \Theta(\mathcal{N}) \in \mathfrak{F}_L \quad (\Theta \in \mathfrak{D}_L).} \quad (67)$$

Consequently  $\succeq_{\mathfrak{D}}$  is a preorder on  $\text{Obj}_L$ .

*Proof.* The identity superchannel is physical, preserves the object class, and trivially commutes with  $\text{rev}$ . For  $\Theta_1, \Theta_2 \in \mathfrak{D}_L$ ,

$$(\Theta_2 \circ \Theta_1)(\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}) = \Theta_2(\Theta_1(\mathcal{N})^{\text{rev}}) = \Theta_2(\Theta_1(\mathcal{N}))^{\text{rev}}, \quad (68)$$

so covariance is preserved by composition; object preservation and physical realizability compose as well. Finally, if  $\mathcal{N} = \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}$ , covariance gives  $\Theta(\mathcal{N}) = \Theta(\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}) = \Theta(\mathcal{N})^{\text{rev}}$ , hence  $\Theta(\mathcal{N}) \in \mathfrak{F}_L$ .  $\square$

**Remark 13** (Formal reciprocity projection). *The affine map*

$$\Pi_{\text{rec}}(\mathcal{N}) = \frac{1}{2}(\mathcal{N} + \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}) \quad (69)$$

*always produces a reciprocal bistochastic channel. It is a formal proof device and is not assumed to be an operationally free superchannel on an unknown input.*

### III. FAITHFUL FIXED-TIME CHANNEL RESOURCE MONOTONES

**Definition 18** (Channel asymmetry). *Define*

$$\boxed{A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}) = \frac{1}{2}\|\mathcal{N} - \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}\|_{\diamond}.} \quad (70)$$

**Proposition 6** (Operational channel-reciprocity discrimination). *Suppose one receives a black-box channel that is promised to be either  $\mathcal{N}$  or  $\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}$  with equal prior probabilities. Then the optimal one-shot discrimination success probability is*

$$\boxed{p_{\text{succ}}^{\text{opt}} = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}\|\mathcal{N} - \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}\|_{\diamond} = \frac{1 + A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N})}{2}.} \quad (71)$$

*Equivalently,*

$$\boxed{A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}) = 2p_{\text{succ}}^{\text{opt}} - 1 = 2\left(p_{\text{succ}}^{\text{opt}} - \frac{1}{2}\right).} \quad (72)$$

*Thus  $A_{\diamond}$  is exactly twice the optimal one-shot advantage over random guessing for detecting transpose-reciprocity breaking.*

*Proof.* The Helstrom theorem for discrimination of quantum channels gives

$$p_{\text{succ}}^{\text{opt}}(\mathcal{N}, \mathcal{M}) = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}\|\mathcal{N} - \mathcal{M}\|_{\diamond}. \quad (73)$$

Set  $\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}$ .  $\square$

**Remark 14** (Operational meaning). *The diamond norm optimizes over reference systems:*

$$\|\mathcal{N} - \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}\|_{\diamond} = \sup_{\rho_{RE}} \|(\mathcal{N} \otimes \mathbb{1}_R)(\rho_{RE}) - (\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} \otimes \mathbb{1}_R)(\rho_{RE})\|_1. \quad (74)$$

*Thus  $A_{\diamond}$  compares the coherent quantum processes themselves rather than only classical transition probabilities.*

**Theorem 1** (Monotonicity and faithfulness of channel asymmetry). *For every free superchannel  $\Theta \in \mathfrak{D}_L$ ,*

$$\boxed{A_{\diamond}(\Theta(\mathcal{N})) \leq A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}).} \quad (75)$$

*Moreover,*

$$\boxed{A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}) = 0 \iff \mathcal{N} \in \mathfrak{F}_L.} \quad (76)$$

*Proof.* Covariance gives

$$[\Theta(\mathcal{N})]^{\text{rev}} = \Theta(\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}), \quad (77)$$

and hence

$$A_{\diamond}(\Theta(\mathcal{N})) = \frac{1}{2}\|\Theta(\mathcal{N} - \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}})\|_{\diamond}. \quad (78)$$

Any physical superchannel is contractive for the diamond norm, giving the inequality. Faithfulness is immediate from the definition of  $\mathfrak{F}_L$ .  $\square$

**Definition 19** (Generalized channel robustness). *Define*

$$\boxed{R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}) = \inf \left\{ s \geq 0 : \frac{\mathcal{N} + s\mathcal{M}}{1+s} \in \mathfrak{F}_L, \exists \mathcal{M} \in \text{Obj}_L \right\}.} \quad (79)$$

**Theorem 2** (Faithfulness and monotonicity of robustness). *For every free superchannel  $\Theta \in \mathfrak{D}_L$ ,*

$$\boxed{R_{\text{rob}}(\Theta(\mathcal{N})) \leq R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}),} \quad (80)$$

*and*

$$\boxed{R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}) = 0 \iff \mathcal{N} \in \mathfrak{F}_L.} \quad (81)$$

*Proof.* If

$$\mathcal{F} = \frac{\mathcal{N} + s\mathcal{M}}{1+s} \in \mathfrak{F}_L, \quad (82)$$

then covariance and linearity give

$$\Theta(\mathcal{F}) = \frac{\Theta(\mathcal{N}) + s\Theta(\mathcal{M})}{1+s} \in \mathfrak{F}_L. \quad (83)$$

Thus the same  $s$  is feasible after  $\Theta$ .

Conversely, if  $R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}) = 0$ , there is a sequence  $s_k \rightarrow 0$  and  $\mathcal{F}_k \in \mathfrak{F}_L$  with

$$\mathcal{F}_k = \frac{\mathcal{N} + s_k\mathcal{M}_k}{1+s_k}. \quad (84)$$

The finite-dimensional channel set is compact, so the feasible  $\mathcal{M}_k$  are uniformly bounded in diamond norm. Hence  $\|\mathcal{F}_k - \mathcal{N}\|_{\diamond} \rightarrow 0$ ; closedness of  $\mathfrak{F}_L$  then implies  $\mathcal{N} \in \mathfrak{F}_L$ .  $\square$

**Remark 15** (Attainment of the robustness infimum). The infimum defining  $R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N})$  is in fact attained for every  $\mathcal{N} \in \text{Obj}_L$  at finite  $L$ . The feasible set

$$\left\{ (s, \mathcal{M}) \in [0, \infty) \times \text{Obj}_L : \frac{\mathcal{N} + s\mathcal{M}}{1+s} \in \mathfrak{F}_L \right\} \quad (85)$$

is nonempty (Proposition 7 exhibits  $s = 1$ ,  $\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}$  as feasible), and for  $s$  ranging over any compact interval  $[0, 1]$  the set of admissible  $\mathcal{M} \in \text{Obj}_L$  is compact (closed and bounded in the finite-dimensional diamond norm), with the constraint  $\frac{\mathcal{N} + s\mathcal{M}}{1+s} \in \mathfrak{F}_L$  defining a closed subset of this compact set by continuity of  $(s, \mathcal{M}) \mapsto \frac{\mathcal{N} + s\mathcal{M}}{1+s}$  and closedness of  $\mathfrak{F}_L$ . The projection of a closed subset of a compact set onto the  $s$ -coordinate is compact, hence closed, so the infimum over  $s$  is attained by a minimizing pair  $(s^*, \mathcal{M}^*)$ . This attainment is used implicitly throughout (e.g. in Proposition 16's construction of a specific feasible  $\mathcal{M}$  realizing a target robustness value) and is recorded here explicitly for completeness.

**Proposition 7** (Global boundedness and tensor-power collapse). For every finite-size channel,

$$0 \leq A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}) \leq R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}) \leq 1. \quad (86)$$

For every  $n \geq 1$ ,

$$A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}^{\otimes n}) \leq 1, \quad R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}^{\otimes n}) \leq 1, \quad (87)$$

so

$$\limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}^{\otimes n})}{n} = 0, \quad \limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}^{\otimes n})}{n} = 0. \quad (88)$$

Thus the global fixed-time channel measures in this normalization are persistence-type quantities rather than extensive tensor-power rates.

*Proof.* The diamond distance between two channels is at most 2, hence  $A_{\diamond} \leq 1$ . For robustness, choose  $\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}$ :

$$\frac{\mathcal{N} + \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}}{2} \in \mathfrak{F}_L. \quad (89)$$

This gives  $R_{\text{rob}} \leq 1$ . The same argument applies to tensor powers using

$$(\mathcal{N}^{\otimes n})^{\text{rev}} = (\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}})^{\otimes n}. \quad (90)$$

□

**Proposition 8** (Max-relative-entropy form of the robustness and structural boundedness). For  $\mathcal{N} \in \text{Obj}_L$  define

$$R_{\text{max}}(\mathcal{N}) = \min_{\mathcal{F} \in \mathfrak{F}_L} \log \min\{\lambda \geq 1 : \lambda\mathcal{F} - \mathcal{N} \text{ completely positive}\}. \quad (91)$$

Then: (i)  $R_{\text{max}}(\mathcal{N}) = \log(1 + R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}))$ ; (ii)  $R_{\text{max}}$  is faithful and nonincreasing under every  $\Theta \in \mathfrak{D}_L$ ; (iii) for every  $n$ , the same quantity for  $\mathcal{N}^{\otimes n}$ , with the free set of the  $n$ -copy space defined by the same involution, satisfies  $R_{\text{max}}(\mathcal{N}^{\otimes n}) \leq \log 2$ .

*Proof.* (i) If  $\lambda\mathcal{F} - \mathcal{N}$  is completely positive, with  $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{N}$  trace-preserving, then its trace is  $\lambda - 1 \geq 0$ . For  $s = \lambda - 1 > 0$  the map  $\mathcal{M} = (\lambda\mathcal{F} - \mathcal{N})/s$  is CP, trace preserving and unital, i.e.  $\mathcal{M} \in \text{Obj}_L$ , and  $(\mathcal{N} + s\mathcal{M})/(1+s) = \mathcal{F} \in \mathfrak{F}_L$ ; the converse direction is the same computation read backwards. Minimizing over  $\mathcal{F}$  and using the attainment of Remark 15 gives (i). (ii) Faithfulness is Theorem 2's statement transported by (i); for monotonicity,  $\Theta(\mathcal{F}) \in \mathfrak{F}_L$  by covariance, and  $\lambda\Theta(\mathcal{F}) - \Theta(\mathcal{N}) = \Theta(\lambda\mathcal{F} - \mathcal{N})$  is CP, because a physical superchannel maps CP maps to CP maps. (iii)  $(\mathcal{N}^{\otimes n})^{\text{rev}} = (\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}})^{\otimes n}$ , so  $\mathcal{F}_n = \frac{1}{2}[\mathcal{N}^{\otimes n} + (\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}})^{\otimes n}]$  is reciprocal and  $2\mathcal{F}_n - \mathcal{N}^{\otimes n} = (\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}})^{\otimes n}$  is CP, so  $\lambda = 2$  is feasible. □

**Remark 16** (No extensive rates from a  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  covariance). The bound in (iii) is uniform in  $n$ , and any channel divergence dominated by the max-relative entropy inherits it. This is the general finite-group phenomenon (cf. the asymmetry of states and channels under a finite group [17] and channel divergences [18]): asymmetry with respect to a single involution cannot be extensive in tensor powers. It explains Proposition 7 and is why extensivity in this paper is obtained only through the explicit cellwise construction of Sec. XVI. Asymptotic distillation and dilution rates are not defined here and remain open.

**Corollary 3** (Robustness dominates channel asymmetry). For every channel,

$$A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}) \leq R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}). \quad (92)$$

*Proof.* If  $s, \mathcal{M}$  are feasible, then the free mixture obeys

$$\mathcal{N} - \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} = -s(\mathcal{M} - \mathcal{M}^{\text{rev}}), \quad (93)$$

and the diamond distance between two channels is at most 2. Hence  $A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}) \leq s$ , and infimization gives the result. □

## A. Thermodynamic persistence

**Definition 20** (Thermodynamic channel family). A fixed-time family  $\{\mathcal{N}_{L,t}\}_{L \geq 1}$  is thermodynamically admissible if, for every compact operational time interval  $\mathcal{T}_0$ , the family admits quasi-local Kraus representations with constants  $C_{\mathcal{T}_0}, \mu_{\mathcal{T}_0} > 0$  independent of  $L$  and  $t \in \mathcal{T}_0$ , and each  $\mathcal{N}_{L,t}$  belongs to  $\text{Obj}_L$ .

**Definition 21** (Thermodynamic persistence). Define

$$A_{\diamond,\infty}(t) = \limsup_{L \rightarrow \infty} A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_{L,t}), \quad (94)$$

and

$$R_{\text{rob},\infty}(t) = \limsup_{L \rightarrow \infty} R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}_{L,t}). \quad (95)$$

These are persistence quantities, not extensive densities.

**Proposition 9** (Thermodynamic monotonicity). *For a thermodynamically free superchannel family  $\{\Theta_L\}_{L \geq 1} \in \mathfrak{D}_\infty$ ,*

$$\boxed{A_{\diamond, \infty}[\Theta(\mathcal{N})] \leq A_{\diamond, \infty}(\mathcal{N}), \quad R_{\text{rob}, \infty}[\Theta(\mathcal{N})] \leq R_{\text{rob}, \infty}(\mathcal{N}).} \quad (96)$$

*Proof.* Apply the finite-size monotonicity inequalities at every  $L$  and take the thermodynamic limsup. The family-level locality certificate is what makes the resulting sequence an element of the thermodynamic free-operation class rather than merely a list of unrelated finite-size maps.  $\square$

#### IV. NORMALIZATION GAUGE AS PART OF THE OPERATIONAL SPECIFICATION

The channel resource defined in this work depends on a scalar normalization of the non-Hermitian propagator. This dependence is not an ambiguity to be hidden: the normalization convention is part of the operational specification of the present channel QRT. What is intrinsic within the strict scalar class is the reciprocity support  $A_\diamond = 0$  versus  $A_\diamond > 0$ , whereas the numerical value of  $A_\diamond$  depends quantitatively on the chosen normalization gauge.

**Definition 22** (Admissible scalar normalization gauge). *Let  $\mathcal{H}_{\text{adm}}$  be a Hamiltonian class closed under transpose,  $H \mapsto H^T$ . An admissible scalar normalization gauge is a positive function*

$$\kappa : \mathcal{H}_{\text{adm}} \times \mathcal{T} \rightarrow (0, \infty), \quad (H, t) \mapsto \kappa(H, t), \quad (97)$$

satisfying the following conditions.

##### 1. Strict contraction:

$$\boxed{\kappa(H, t) > \|U_H(t)\|_\infty^2, \quad U_H(t) = e^{-iHt}.} \quad (98)$$

##### 2. Transpose invariance:

$$\boxed{\kappa(H^T, t) = \kappa(H, t).} \quad (99)$$

##### 3. Thermodynamic uniformity: for every thermodynamic family $\{H_L\}_{L \geq 1}$ and every compact interval $\mathcal{T}_0 \ni 0$ on which

$$\sup_L \sup_{t \in \mathcal{T}_0} \|U_{H_L}(t)\|_\infty < \infty, \quad (100)$$

there are finite constants  $0 < \kappa_- < \kappa_+ < \infty$  such that

$$\boxed{\kappa_- \leq \kappa(H_L, t) \leq \kappa_+} \quad (101)$$

uniformly in  $L$  and  $t \in \mathcal{T}_0$ .

##### 4. Short-time regularity: when a short-time expansion is invoked, there exists $\kappa_0 > 0$ such that

$$\boxed{\kappa(H_L, t) = \kappa_0 + O(t)} \quad (102)$$

uniformly in  $L$  within the thermodynamic family under consideration.

Given such a gauge, define

$$\boxed{K_{H,t}^{(\kappa)} = \frac{U_H(t)}{\sqrt{\kappa(H, t)}},} \quad (103)$$

and

$$\boxed{\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{(\kappa)} = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{K_{H,t}^{(\kappa)}}} \quad (104)$$

be its canonical Julia-completed channel.

**Remark 17** (Operational status of the normalization gauge). *The scalar normalization gauge is part of the operational definition of the QRT. Accordingly, the statement  $A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{(\kappa)})$  refers to a channel resource evaluated after the gauge  $\kappa$  has been fixed. The present theory does not claim that the numerical magnitude of  $A_\diamond$  is a representation-independent invariant of the bare Hamiltonian  $H$  under arbitrary changes of normalization. What is proved below is that the reciprocity support of the resource is invariant within the admissible strict scalar class, and that quantitative values are equivalent up to explicit continuity bounds inside a common strict-contraction region.*

**Proposition 10** (Exact reciprocity criterion for a strict Julia dilation). *Let  $K$  satisfy*

$$\|K\|_\infty \leq q < 1. \quad (105)$$

Then

$$\boxed{\tilde{\mathcal{E}}_K^{\text{rev}} = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_K \iff K^T = K.} \quad (106)$$

*Proof.* The forward implication from  $K^T = K$  is Proposition 1. Conversely, equality of the two unitary-conjugation channels implies

$$\tilde{U}_K^T = e^{i\phi} \tilde{U}_K \quad (107)$$

for some phase. Transposing again gives  $e^{2i\phi} = 1$ . If  $\phi = \pi$ , the upper-right block would satisfy

$$D_K^T = -D_{K^\dagger}. \quad (108)$$

Taking traces gives

$$\text{Tr}(D_K) = -\text{Tr}(D_{K^\dagger}), \quad (109)$$

which is impossible because both defect operators are positive definite and hence have strictly positive traces. Thus  $\phi = 0$ , and the  $(1, 1)$  block gives  $K^T = K$ .  $\square$

**Proposition 11** (Gauge-invariant reciprocity support). *Let  $\kappa_1$  and  $\kappa_2$  be any two admissible strict scalar normalization gauges. Then for every finite-dimensional  $H$  and every operational time  $t$ ,*

$$A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{(\kappa_1)}) = 0 \iff A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{(\kappa_2)}) = 0. \quad (110)$$

More precisely,

$$A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{(\kappa)}) = 0 \iff U_H(t)^T = U_H(t). \quad (111)$$

*Proof.* For an admissible scalar normalization,

$$K_{H,t}^{(\kappa)} = \frac{U_H(t)}{\sqrt{\kappa(H,t)}}, \quad (112)$$

and therefore

$$(K_{H,t}^{(\kappa)})^T = K_{H,t}^{(\kappa)} \iff U_H(t)^T = U_H(t). \quad (113)$$

Because the contraction is strict, Proposition 10 applies and gives

$$A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{(\kappa)}) = 0 \iff (K_{H,t}^{(\kappa)})^T = K_{H,t}^{(\kappa)}. \quad (114)$$

Combining the two equivalences proves the result.  $\square$

**Proposition 12** (Uniform quantitative equivalence of normalization gauges). *Let  $\kappa_1$  and  $\kappa_2$  be two normalization gauges for the same propagator  $U_H(t)$ , and suppose that on the domain of interest*

$$\|K_j(H,t)\|_\infty \leq q < 1, \quad K_j(H,t) = \frac{U_H(t)}{\sqrt{\kappa_j(H,t)}}, \quad j = 1, 2. \quad (115)$$

Then

$$\boxed{\left| A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{(\kappa_1)}) - A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{(\kappa_2)}) \right| \leq C(q) \|U_H(t)\|_\infty \left| \kappa_1(H,t)^{-1/2} - \kappa_2(H,t)^{-1/2} \right|,} \quad \begin{matrix} K^{(\kappa)} \longrightarrow 0, \\ \text{and therefore} \end{matrix} \quad D_{K^{(\kappa)}} \longrightarrow \mathbb{1}, \quad D_{K^{(\kappa)\dagger}} \longrightarrow \mathbb{1}, \quad (116)$$

where

$$C(q) = 2 \left( 1 + \frac{q}{\sqrt{1-q^2}} \right). \quad (117)$$

*Proof.* Set

$$X_j = K_j^\dagger K_j, \quad D_{K_j} = (\mathbb{1} - X_j)^{1/2}. \quad (118)$$

Then

$$\|X_1 - X_2\|_\infty \leq (\|K_1\|_\infty + \|K_2\|_\infty) \|K_1 - K_2\|_\infty \leq 2q \|K_1 - K_2\|_\infty. \quad (119)$$

Set  $Y_j = \mathbb{1} - X_j \geq (1 - q^2)\mathbb{1}$  and  $Z = D_{K_1} - D_{K_2}$ . Then  $D_{K_1}Z + ZD_{K_2} = Y_1 - Y_2$ , so  $Z = \int_0^\infty e^{-sD_{K_1}} (Y_1 - Y_2) e^{-sD_{K_2}} ds$  and, because  $D_{K_j} \geq \sqrt{1 - q^2} \mathbb{1}$ ,  $\|Z\|_\infty \leq$

$\|Y_1 - Y_2\|_\infty / (2\sqrt{1 - q^2})$ . Combining with  $\|X_1 - X_2\|_\infty \leq 2q \|K_1 - K_2\|_\infty$  gives

$$\|D_{K_1} - D_{K_2}\|_\infty \leq \frac{q}{\sqrt{1 - q^2}} \|K_1 - K_2\|_\infty. \quad (120)$$

The same estimate holds for the complementary defect  $D_{K_j^\dagger}$ . Hence

$$\|\tilde{U}_{K_1} - \tilde{U}_{K_2}\|_\infty \leq \left( 1 + \frac{q}{\sqrt{1 - q^2}} \right) \|K_1 - K_2\|_\infty. \quad (121)$$

For unitary channels,

$$\|\mathcal{U}_1 - \mathcal{U}_2\|_\diamond \leq 2 \|U_1 - U_2\|_\infty, \quad (122)$$

and the same estimate applies to the transposed unitary channels. Using the triangle inequality in the definition of  $A_\diamond$  gives

$$|A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_1) - A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_2)| \leq 2 \left( 1 + \frac{q}{\sqrt{1 - q^2}} \right) \|K_1 - K_2\|_\infty. \quad (123)$$

Finally,

$$\|K_1 - K_2\|_\infty = \|U_H(t)\|_\infty \left| \kappa_1(H,t)^{-1/2} - \kappa_2(H,t)^{-1/2} \right|, \quad (124)$$

which proves the claim.  $\square$

**Proposition 13** (Large-normalization degeneration). *For fixed  $H$  and  $t$ , let*

$$K^{(\kappa)} = \frac{U_H(t)}{\sqrt{\kappa}}, \quad \kappa > \|U_H(t)\|_\infty^2. \quad (125)$$

Then

$$D_{K^{(\kappa)}} \longrightarrow \mathbb{1}, \quad D_{K^{(\kappa)\dagger}} \longrightarrow \mathbb{1}, \quad (126)$$

$$\tilde{U}_{K^{(\kappa)}} \longrightarrow \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \mathbb{1} \\ \mathbb{1} & 0 \end{pmatrix} =: S. \quad (127)$$

Since  $S^T = S$ ,

$$\boxed{\lim_{\kappa \rightarrow \infty} A_\diamond(\tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{K^{(\kappa)}}) = 0.} \quad (128)$$

Thus the numerical value of the channel resource cannot be regarded as a normalization-independent quantity under arbitrary scalar rescaling.

The convergence of  $K^{(\kappa)}$  is immediate. Functional calculus gives  $D_{K^{(\kappa)}} \rightarrow \mathbb{1}$  and  $D_{K^{(\kappa)\dagger}} \rightarrow \mathbb{1}$ , hence the Julia operator converges to  $S$ . Continuity of unitary channels in the diamond norm then implies convergence of the corresponding channel asymmetry.  $\square$

**Theorem 3** (Normalization-gauge principle). *Within the strict scalar normalization class, the present QRT has the following separation between intrinsic and gauge-dependent information:*

1. The fixed-time support statement

$$A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}) = 0 \iff U_H(t)^T = U_H(t) \quad (129)$$

is independent of the admissible scalar normalization gauge.

2. Numerical resource values are not invariant under arbitrary normalization changes, but are quantitatively equivalent under a common strict-contraction bound according to Proposition 12.

3. The trajectory-derived resource based on the per-Hamiltonian tight normalization is invariant under positive overall energy rescaling when the full positive-time domain is optimized.

*Proof.* Items (1) and (2) are respectively Proposition 11 and Proposition 12. Item (3) follows from Lemma 5, introduced below.  $\square$

**Remark 18** (Interpretation). *The physically invariant statement supplied by the present construction is therefore a statement about transpose-reciprocity breaking and its operational detectability after a specified normalization gauge has been fixed. Claims about absolute resource magnitudes are always understood relative to that gauge.*

## V. TIME-OPTIMIZED TRAJECTORY-DERIVED RESOURCE

**Definition 23** (Per-Hamiltonian tight normalization gauge). *For a fixed finite-dimensional Hamiltonian  $H$ , fix  $\varepsilon_0 > 0$  and define*

$$\kappa_H^{\text{tight}}(t) = (1 + \varepsilon_0) \|U_H(t)\|_\infty^2. \quad (130)$$

Then

$$K_{H,t}^{\text{tight}} = \frac{U_H(t)}{\sqrt{\kappa_H^{\text{tight}}(t)}} \quad (131)$$

satisfies

$$\|K_{H,t}^{\text{tight}}\|_\infty = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 + \varepsilon_0}} =: q_{\text{tight}} < 1. \quad (132)$$

For the remainder of this manuscript,  $\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{\text{tight}}$  denotes the canonical Julia channel generated by this gauge.

**Definition 24** (Trajectory-derived resources). *For a Hamiltonian  $H$  and an operational time domain  $\mathcal{T} \subset (0, \infty)$ , define the gauge-dependent trajectory resources*

$$A_{\diamond,\kappa}^{\text{sup}}(H; \mathcal{T}) = \sup_{t \in \mathcal{T}} A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{(\kappa)}), \quad (133)$$

and

$$R_{\text{rob},\kappa}^{\text{sup}}(H; \mathcal{T}) = \sup_{t \in \mathcal{T}} R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{(\kappa)}). \quad (134)$$

When the tight gauge of Definition 23 is used and  $\mathcal{T} = (0, \infty)$ , we abbreviate

$$A_\diamond^{\text{sup}}(H) = A_{\diamond,\text{tight}}^{\text{sup}}(H; (0, \infty)), \quad R_{\text{rob}}^{\text{sup}}(H) = R_{\text{rob,tight}}^{\text{sup}}(H; (0, \infty)) \quad (135)$$

**Lemma 5** (Exact scale covariance of the tight gauge). *For every  $\lambda > 0$ ,*

$$\mathcal{N}_{\lambda H,t}^{\text{tight}} = \mathcal{N}_{H,\lambda t}^{\text{tight}}. \quad (136)$$

Consequently,

$$A_\diamond^{\text{sup}}(\lambda H) = A_\diamond^{\text{sup}}(H), \quad R_{\text{rob}}^{\text{sup}}(\lambda H) = R_{\text{rob}}^{\text{sup}}(H). \quad (137)$$

*Proof.* Since

$$U_{\lambda H}(t) = U_H(\lambda t), \quad (138)$$

one has

$$\|U_{\lambda H}(t)\|_\infty = \|U_H(\lambda t)\|_\infty, \quad (139)$$

and therefore

$$\kappa_{\lambda H}^{\text{tight}}(t) = \kappa_H^{\text{tight}}(\lambda t). \quad (140)$$

Hence

$$K_{\lambda H,t}^{\text{tight}} = K_{H,\lambda t}^{\text{tight}}, \quad (141)$$

which gives the first identity. The second follows by the bijection  $s = \lambda t$  of  $(0, \infty)$ .  $\square$

**Definition 25** (Pointwise trajectory-level free transformation). *Let  $\mathcal{T} \subset (0, \infty)$  be an operational time domain and let  $\mathfrak{N} = \{\mathcal{N}_t\}_{t \in \mathcal{T}}$  be a trajectory with  $\mathcal{N}_t \in \text{Obj}_L$ . A pointwise trajectory-level free transformation is a family*

$$\mathfrak{f} = \{\Theta_t\}_{t \in \mathcal{T}} \quad (142)$$

with each  $\Theta_t \in \mathfrak{D}_L$  such that

$$(\mathfrak{f}\mathfrak{N})_t := \Theta_t(\mathcal{N}_t), \quad t \in \mathcal{T}, \quad (143)$$

and such that the family preserves the relevant object class and has uniform locality bounds on every compact subinterval of  $\mathcal{T}$ . No independent time reparametrization is included in  $\mathfrak{f}$ ; time reparametrization is treated separately through the exact scale covariance of Lemma 5.

This is deliberately a pointwise derived construction, not a claim of a causal process-supermap or process-tensor resource theory. A single physically time-consistent control protocol would require additional causal compatibility conditions between the maps at different times.

**Theorem 4** (Trajectory-level monotonicity). *For every trajectory-level free transformation  $\mathfrak{f}$ ,*

$$\sup_{t \in \mathcal{T}} A_{\diamond}(\Theta_t(\mathcal{N}_t)) \leq \sup_{t \in \mathcal{T}} A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_t), \quad (144)$$

and

$$\sup_{t \in \mathcal{T}} R_{\text{rob}}(\Theta_t(\mathcal{N}_t)) \leq \sup_{t \in \mathcal{T}} R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}_t). \quad (145)$$

*Proof.* The fixed-time monotonicity theorems apply point-wise in  $t$ , and taking the supremum preserves the inequalities.  $\square$

**Proposition 14** (No fixed-time resource persistence law from skin length alone). *For the uniform Hatano–Nelson family, scaling  $H_{\lambda,g} = \lambda H_g$  leaves*

$$\rho_{\text{GBZ}}(H_{\lambda,g}) = \frac{|g|}{a}, \quad \ell_{\text{skin}} = \frac{a}{|g|}, \quad (146)$$

unchanged, while

$$U_{\lambda,g}(t) = U_g(\lambda t). \quad (147)$$

Under a common fixed normalization  $\kappa(t)$  independent of  $\lambda$ , with uniform thermodynamic bounds,

$$A_{\diamond,\infty}(H_{\lambda,g}; t) \rightarrow 0 \quad (\lambda \rightarrow 0) \quad (148)$$

at fixed operational time. Hence a fixed-time persistence number cannot be a universal quantitative function of skin length alone.

*Proof.* The GBZ radius is determined by the hopping ratio and is invariant under overall energy rescaling. At fixed  $t$ ,

$$\|U_{\lambda,g}(t) - \mathbb{1}\|_{\infty} \leq e^{\lambda \|H_g\|_{\infty} t} - 1 \rightarrow 0. \quad (149)$$

The associated normalized propagator converges to a scalar multiple of  $\mathbb{1}$ , whose Julia channel is reciprocal. Continuity of the Julia completion and of  $A_{\diamond}$  therefore gives the stated vanishing limit.  $\square$

## VI. FREE SUPERCHANNELS, DILUTION, AND THE EXACT SCOPE OF CONVERSION

**Proposition 15** (No-ancilla covariant realization). *Let  $\Gamma \in \text{Obj}_L$  and define*

$$\Theta_{\Gamma}(\mathcal{N}) = \Gamma^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{N} \circ \Gamma. \quad (150)$$

Then  $\Theta_{\Gamma}$  is a physical free superchannel.

*Proof.* Bistochasticity of  $\Gamma$  implies bistochasticity of  $\Gamma^{\text{rev}}$ . Quasi-locality and object preservation follow from  $\Gamma \in \text{Obj}_L$  and Lemma 3. By Lemma 4,

$$[\Theta_{\Gamma}(\mathcal{N})]^{\text{rev}} = (\Gamma^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{N} \circ \Gamma)^{\text{rev}} \quad (151)$$

$$= \Gamma^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}} \circ \Gamma \quad (152)$$

$$= \Theta_{\Gamma}(\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}). \quad (153)$$

Thus the covariance condition holds.  $\square$

**Proposition 16** (Covariant dilution by a reciprocal branch). *Fix  $\mathcal{R}_0 \in \mathfrak{F}_L$  and  $p \in [0, 1]$ . Suppose the laboratory control model admits a deterministic randomized switch that applies  $\mathcal{N}$  with probability  $p$  and the fixed reciprocal channel  $\mathcal{R}_0$  with probability  $1-p$ , with no object-class violation. Then*

$$\Theta_p(\mathcal{N}) = p\mathcal{N} + (1-p)\mathcal{R}_0 \quad (154)$$

is a free superchannel and

$$A_{\diamond}(\Theta_p(\mathcal{N})) = pA_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}), \quad R_{\text{rob}}(\Theta_p(\mathcal{N})) \leq pR_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}). \quad (155)$$

*Proof.* The covariance and asymmetry identity follow by linearity. If

$$\frac{\mathcal{N} + s\mathcal{M}}{1+s} = \mathcal{F} \in \mathfrak{F}_L, \quad (156)$$

then

$$\Theta_p(\mathcal{N}) + ps\mathcal{M} = p(1+s)\mathcal{F} + (1-p)\mathcal{R}_0, \quad (157)$$

which is free after division by  $1+ps$ . Hence  $ps$  is feasible, and taking the infimum gives the robustness bound.  $\square$

**Definition 26** (Ancilla-free superchannel). *A superchannel is ancilla free if it has the form*

$$\Theta(\mathcal{N}) = \Gamma_{\text{post}} \circ \mathcal{N} \circ \Gamma_{\text{pre}} \quad (158)$$

with no memory system. The main QRT does not assume that arbitrary ancilla-free covariant superchannels can be classified from covariance restricted to  $\text{Obj}_L$ .

**Definition 27** (Unitary-congruence free subclass). *For a unitary  $V$  let  $\mathcal{V}(X) = VXV^{\dagger}$ . Define*

$$\Theta_V(\mathcal{N}) = \mathcal{V}^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{N} \circ \mathcal{V}, \quad \mathcal{V}^{\text{rev}}(X) = V^T X V^*. \quad (159)$$

For each finite  $L$ ,  $\mathfrak{D}_{\text{uc}}(L)$  denotes the set of such  $\Theta_V$  that preserve  $\text{Obj}_L$ ; for thermodynamic families we additionally require uniform quasi-locality of the implementing unitaries. Every member is a deterministic, ancilla-free, physical free superchannel.

**Remark 19.** *The full ancilla-assisted covariant superchannel class, and even the full ancilla-free covariant class beyond  $\mathfrak{D}_{\text{uc}}(L)$ , are not classified here. In particular, deterministic attenuation  $\mathcal{N}_g \rightarrow \mathcal{N}_{g'}$  for  $|g'| < |g|$  is not inferred from the monotones. Any sufficiency statement for the full class requires an explicit physical protocol.*

## VII. CONCRETE HATANO–NELSON CHANNEL CALIBRATION

Consider the two-site calibration Hamiltonian

$$H_0 = m\mathbb{1} + t_0(|1\rangle\langle 2| + |2\rangle\langle 1|), \quad (160)$$

and the gauge family

$$H_g = S_g H_0 S_g^{-1}, \quad S_g |1\rangle = |1\rangle, \quad S_g |2\rangle = e^{-g} |2\rangle, \quad (161)$$

so that

$$H_g = m \mathbb{1} + t_0 (e^g |1\rangle\langle 2| + e^{-g} |2\rangle\langle 1|). \quad (162)$$

Throughout this calibration, we assume  $m, t_0 \in \mathbb{R}$  with  $t_0 > 0$ .

At

$$\tau_* = \frac{\pi}{2t_0}, \quad (163)$$

one has, up to the global phase  $e^{-im\tau_*}$ ,

$$U_g(\tau_*) = -i \begin{pmatrix} 0 & e^g \\ e^{-g} & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \|U_g(\tau_*)\|_\infty = e^{|g|}. \quad (164)$$

For a common normalization  $\kappa > e^{2g_{\max}}$  on  $|g| \leq g_{\max}$ , set

$$u = \kappa^{-1/2}. \quad (165)$$

Then

$$K_g = -iu \begin{pmatrix} 0 & e^g \\ e^{-g} & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad (166)$$

and the Julia defects are

$$D_K = \text{diag}(a, b), \quad D_{K^\dagger} = \text{diag}(b, a), \quad (167)$$

with

$$a = \sqrt{1 - u^2 e^{-2g}}, \quad b = \sqrt{1 - u^2 e^{2g}}. \quad (168)$$

**Theorem 5** (Exact two-site channel asymmetry). *For the two-site Hatano–Nelson calibration at  $\tau_*$ ,*

$$A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{g, \tau_*}) = \sqrt{1 - c(g)^2}, \quad (169)$$

where

$$c(g) = u^2 + \sqrt{(1 - u^2 e^{2g})(1 - u^2 e^{-2g})}. \quad (170)$$

Moreover, for  $g > 0$ ,

$$\frac{d}{dg} A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{g, \tau_*}) > 0. \quad (171)$$

*Proof.* The relative unitary for discrimination of  $\tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{K_g}$  and  $\tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{K_g}^{\text{rev}}$  is

$$W_g = \tilde{U}_{K_g}^\dagger \tilde{U}_{K_g}^T. \quad (172)$$

For the calibration unitary, direct block multiplication gives that the spectrum of  $W_g$  consists of  $e^{\pm i\theta(g)}$ , each with multiplicity two, with

$$\cos \theta(g) = u^2 + ab = c(g). \quad (173)$$

For unitary channels, the exact discrimination formula gives

$$\frac{1}{2} \|\mathcal{U} - \mathcal{V}\|_\diamond = \sqrt{1 - \nu(W)^2}, \quad (174)$$

where

$$\nu(W) = \min_{\|\psi\|=1} |\langle \psi | W | \psi \rangle|. \quad (175)$$

Because the spectrum is  $e^{\pm i\theta}$  with  $0 \leq \theta \leq \pi/2$  in the strict calibration regime, the numerical range is the line segment between these two eigenvalues and  $\nu(W) = \cos \theta = c(g)$ . Hence

$$A_\diamond = \sqrt{1 - c(g)^2}. \quad (176)$$

Writing  $y = e^{2g} > 1$  gives

$$c(g) = u^2 + \sqrt{1 + u^4 - u^2(y + y^{-1})}, \quad (177)$$

hence

$$c'(g) = -\frac{u^2(y - y^{-1})}{\sqrt{1 + u^4 - u^2(y + y^{-1})}} < 0. \quad (178)$$

Therefore  $A'_\diamond(g) > 0$ .  $\square$

**Corollary 4** (Exact scalar ordering on the calibration orbit). *For the common normalization of Theorem 5,*

$$|g| \geq |g'| \iff A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{g, \tau_*}) \geq A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{g', \tau_*}). \quad (179)$$

Consequently every deterministic free conversion  $\mathcal{N}_{g, \tau_*} \succeq_\diamond \mathcal{N}_{g', \tau_*}$  must satisfy

$$|g| \geq |g'|. \quad (180)$$

*Proof.* The first statement follows from evenness in  $g$  and strict monotonicity in  $|g|$ . The second follows from monotonicity of  $A_\diamond$  under free superchannels.  $\square$

**Lemma 6** (Phase-invariant unitary-congruence diagnostic). *For a unitary  $U$  acting on a  $d$ -dimensional space define the unitary-congruence cosquare*

$$C_{\text{cs}}(U) = U^* U, \quad \chi_{\text{cs}}(U) = \frac{1}{d^2} |\text{Tr}(U^* U)|^2. \quad (181)$$

Under

$$U \mapsto e^{i\phi} V^T U V, \quad (182)$$

one has

$$\chi_{\text{cs}}(e^{i\phi} V^T U V) = \chi_{\text{cs}}(U). \quad (183)$$

For the two-site Julia unitary at  $\tau_*$ ,

$$\chi_{\text{cs}}(\tilde{U}_{K_g}) = c(g)^2, \quad (184)$$

with  $c(g)$  from Theorem 5. Since  $c(g) > 0$  and is strictly decreasing in  $|g|$  for  $|g| > 0$ ,  $\chi_{\text{cs}}$  is strictly decreasing in  $|g|$  on the calibration orbit.

*Proof.* Let

$$U' = e^{i\phi} V^T U V. \quad (185)$$

Then

$$(U')^* U' = V^\dagger U^* (V^* V^T) U V = V^\dagger (U^* U) V, \quad (186)$$

so  $C_{cs}$  is unitarily similar to the original cosquare and its trace is invariant; the phase cancels exactly. For a unitary  $U$ ,

$$U^* U = (U^\dagger U^T)^\dagger, \quad (187)$$

so it has the complex-conjugate eigenvalue multiset of the discrimination relative unitary. In the present calibration the spectrum is the conjugate-symmetric set  $e^{\pm i\theta}$ , each twice, and therefore

$$\text{Tr}(\tilde{U}_{K_g}^* \tilde{U}_{K_g}) = 4 \cos \theta(g) = 4c(g). \quad (188)$$

The four-dimensional normalization gives  $\chi_{cs} = c(g)^2$ .  $\square$

**Theorem 6** (No nontrivial conversion in the ancilla-free unitary-congruence subclass). *Suppose  $\Theta_V \in \mathfrak{D}_{uc}(L)$  maps  $\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}$  to  $\mathcal{N}_{g',\tau_*}$ . Then*

$$\boxed{|g| = |g'|}. \quad (189)$$

*Thus no nontrivial attenuation or amplification occurs inside this explicitly defined ancilla-free unitary-congruence subclass.*

*Proof.* Equality of the output unitary channels implies that their implementing unitaries differ only by a global phase, so

$$\tilde{U}_{K_{g'}} = e^{i\phi} V^T \tilde{U}_{K_g} V \quad (190)$$

for some phase  $\phi$ . Lemma 6 therefore gives

$$c(g')^2 = c(g)^2. \quad (191)$$

Both  $c(g)$  and  $c(g')$  are positive, so  $c(g') = c(g)$ ; strict monotonicity in  $|g|$  then implies  $|g| = |g'|$ .  $\square$

**Remark 20** (Status of the full conversion problem). *The rigorous conversion information established here has three distinct layers. First, the monotone  $A_\diamond$  gives the necessary condition  $|g| \geq |g'|$  for any free conversion on the calibration orbit. Second, the explicitly defined subclass  $\mathfrak{D}_{uc}(L)$  is rigid: within it,  $|g|$  cannot change at all. Third, the full ancilla-assisted preorder remains open. In particular, the sufficient direction*

$$|g| > |g'| \implies \mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*} \succeq_{\mathfrak{D}} \mathcal{N}_{g',\tau_*} \quad (192)$$

*is not claimed and cannot be inferred from monotonicity alone. Establishing it requires an explicit deterministic attenuation protocol in the full free-operation model. Sec. XVII isolates a concrete obstruction facing the most natural candidate protocol and states this sufficiency direction as a precise, numerically testable conjecture.*

## VIII. EXACT SCOPE OF THE NHSE-RESOURCE CORRESPONDENCE

We stress at the outset of this section that the channel resource constructed above is, and remains, a detector of transpose-reciprocity breaking as an algebraic property of  $H$ . It is *not* a general-purpose detector of the physical phenomenon of non-Hermitian skin accumulation. Conventional non-Hermitian skin accumulation can arise through mechanisms that do not require  $H^T \neq H$  (e.g. genuinely non-Abelian or Lindbladian mechanisms discussed in Sec. XXII), so no universal equivalence between  $A_\diamond^{\text{sup}} > 0$  and “NHSE occurs” is asserted or should be inferred from what follows. The exact logical scope of the correspondence is stated in three layers: a universal statement about transpose-reciprocity breaking (unconditional), a one-way witness statement for the sector where conventional NHSE happens to coincide with transpose-reciprocity breaking, and a biconditional statement that holds only on model classes explicitly shown to satisfy Definition 31. An explicit exact example established here is the uniform Hatano–Nelson family (Proposition 30), where the equivalence is close to definitional: the GBZ radius  $\rho_{\text{GBZ}} = |g|/a$  on that orbit is parametrized by the same  $g$  that controls  $H_g^T \neq H_g$ . The resulting biconditional should therefore be read as an exact solved calibration, not as evidence for a broader universal correspondence.

**Definition 28** (Transpose-reciprocity-breaking class). *Define*

$$\boxed{\mathcal{C}_{\text{TRB}} = \{H : H^T \neq H\}}. \quad (193)$$

**Definition 29** (Conventional NHSE class). *Let  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{NHSE}}^{\text{conv}}$  denote a class of one-dimensional finite-range Hamiltonians with open boundaries satisfying the conventional extensive skin criterion: there exists an extensive bulk spectral window  $I$  and a sequence  $\ell_L = o(L)$  such that*

$$\boxed{\limsup_{L \rightarrow \infty} C_I^{\text{edge}}(L, \ell_L) > 0}. \quad (194)$$

*The definition is based on OBC eigenstate concentration and does not by itself impose transpose reciprocity breaking.*

**Definition 30** (Transpose-reciprocity-breaking conventional NHSE class). *Define*

$$\boxed{\mathcal{C}_{\text{TR-NHSE}} = \mathcal{C}_{\text{TRB}} \cap \mathcal{C}_{\text{NHSE}}^{\text{conv}}}. \quad (195)$$

*Thus membership in  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{TR-NHSE}}$  explicitly includes both conventional OBC skin accumulation and transpose-reciprocity breaking.*

**Theorem 7** (Exact trajectory-level characterization of transpose-reciprocity breaking). *Let  $H$  be finite dimensional and let the operational time domain  $\mathcal{T}$  contain a sequence*

$$t_j \downarrow 0. \quad (196)$$

For any admissible strict scalar normalization  $\kappa$ , define

$$A_{\diamond, \kappa}^{\text{sup}}(H; \mathcal{T}) = \sup_{t \in \mathcal{T}} A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_{H, t}^{(\kappa)}). \quad (197)$$

Then

$$A_{\diamond, \kappa}^{\text{sup}}(H; \mathcal{T}) > 0 \iff H^T \neq H. \quad (198)$$

Equivalently,

$$A_{\diamond, \kappa}^{\text{sup}}(H; \mathcal{T}) = 0 \iff H^T = H. \quad (199)$$

*Proof.* If  $H^T = H$ , then

$$U_H(t)^T = U_H(t) \quad (200)$$

for every  $t$ , and Proposition 4 gives

$$A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_{H, t}^{(\kappa)}) = 0 \quad (201)$$

for every  $t$ . Hence the supremum vanishes.

Conversely, suppose  $H^T \neq H$ . The short-time expansion gives

$$U_H(t)^T - U_H(t) = -i(H^T - H)t + O(t^2). \quad (202)$$

Since  $H^T - H \neq 0$ , the analytic matrix-valued function  $t \mapsto U_H(t)^T - U_H(t)$  has the nonvanishing first-order coefficient  $-i(H^T - H)$ , so there is  $\varepsilon > 0$  with  $U_H(t)^T \neq U_H(t)$  for every  $t \in (0, \varepsilon)$ , not merely along some sequence. Since  $\mathcal{T}$  contains a sequence  $t_j \downarrow 0$ , for all sufficiently large  $j$  one has

$$U_H(t_j)^T \neq U_H(t_j). \quad (203)$$

By Proposition 11,

$$A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_{H, t_j}^{(\kappa)}) > 0, \quad (204)$$

and hence

$$A_{\diamond, \kappa}^{\text{sup}}(H; \mathcal{T}) > 0. \quad (205)$$

□

**Corollary 5** (One-way resource witness for the transpose-breaking NHSE sector). *For every*

$$H \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{TR-NHSE}}, \quad (206)$$

one has

$$A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H) > 0. \quad (207)$$

Thus positivity of the trajectory-derived channel resource is a necessary operational consequence of membership in the transpose-reciprocity-breaking sector of conventional NHSE.

*Proof.* By definition,  $H \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{TR-NHSE}}$  implies  $H^T \neq H$ . Theorem 7 then gives  $A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H) > 0$  for the tight gauge. □

**Remark 21** (What is and is not claimed by the witness theorem). Theorem 7 is a theorem about transpose-reciprocity breaking, not a theorem that every Hamiltonian exhibiting conventional NHSE must satisfy  $H^T \neq H$ . Consequently, the implication

$$\text{conventional NHSE} \implies A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}} > 0 \quad (208)$$

is asserted here only for the explicitly defined sector  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{TR-NHSE}}$ . No universal converse for the full set  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{NHSE}}^{\text{conv}}$  is claimed.

**Proposition 17** (Hermitian and gauge-trivial reciprocity breaking). *Let  $\mathcal{T}$  contain a sequence  $t_j \downarrow 0$  and let  $\kappa$  be an admissible strict normalization.*

1. *If  $H = H^\dagger$  and  $H^T \neq H$  (i.e.  $H$  is not real symmetric), then  $A_{\diamond, \kappa}^{\text{sup}}(H; \mathcal{T}) > 0$ .*
2. *For  $\phi \notin \pi\mathbb{Z}$  and  $L \geq 2$ , the open Hermitian chain  $H_\phi = J \sum_{n=1}^{L-1} (e^{i\phi}|n+1\rangle\langle n| + e^{-i\phi}|n\rangle\langle n+1|)$  has  $A_{\diamond, \kappa}^{\text{sup}}(H_\phi; \mathcal{T}) > 0$ , although  $H_\phi = DH_0D^\dagger$  with the unitary  $D = \text{diag}(e^{i\phi n})$  and  $H_0$  real symmetric, and its eigenvectors have the same moduli as those of  $H_0$  (no skin accumulation).*

*Proof.* (1) Theorem 7 uses only  $H^T \neq H$ ; for  $H = H^\dagger$  one has  $\|U_H(t)\|_\infty = 1$ , so every  $\kappa > 1$  is admissible. (2)  $(H_\phi^T)_{n+1, n} = (H_\phi)_{n, n+1} = Je^{-i\phi} \neq Je^{i\phi} = (H_\phi)_{n+1, n}$  for  $\phi \notin \pi\mathbb{Z}$ , so (1) applies. Moreover  $(DH_0D^\dagger)_{n+1, n} = e^{i\phi(n+1)}Je^{-i\phi n} = Je^{i\phi}$ , and eigenvectors transform as  $\psi_\phi = D\psi_0$ , so  $|\psi_\phi(n)| = |\psi_0(n)|$ . □

**Remark 22** (Consequences for the scope of the resource). (i) Positivity of  $A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}$  does not require non-Hermiticity, and for Hermitian chirality-type reciprocity breaking (e.g. chiral quantum walks [23]) it is genuinely present. The resource is a time-reversal-asymmetry detector (Remark 3); the class  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{TRB}}$  contains Hermitian members, and transpose-reciprocity-complete classes in the sense of Definition 31 must exclude them. (ii) Part 2 shows that the resource depends on the  $U(1)$  site-phase gauge: this is the fixed-frame dependence of Remark 4 made concrete. The imaginary gauge  $S_g$  of the Hatano–Nelson family is non-unitary and physical, so the calibration results are unaffected. (iii) A gauge-invariant refinement, e.g. minimizing  $A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(DHD^\dagger)$  over diagonal phase gauges  $D$ , is natural, but we do not show that it is a monotone under  $\mathfrak{D}_L$ ; this is left open.

**Definition 31** (Transpose-reciprocity-complete NHSE class). *A model class  $\mathcal{C}$  is called transpose-reciprocity complete with respect to conventional NHSE if*

$$H \in \mathcal{C} \implies [H \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{NHSE}}^{\text{conv}} \iff H^T \neq H]. \quad (209)$$

Equivalently, within  $\mathcal{C}$ , conventional OBC skin accumulation and transpose-reciprocity breaking define the same subset.

**Proposition 18** (Transfer of exact NHSE characterization to complete model classes). *Let  $\mathcal{C}$  be a transpose-reciprocity-complete NHSE class in the sense of Definition 31. Suppose its operational time domain contains a sequence  $t_j \downarrow 0$ , and let the channel resource be defined with any admissible strict scalar normalization or with the per-Hamiltonian tight normalization. Then*

$$H \in \mathcal{C} \implies [A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H) > 0 \iff H \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{NHSE}}^{\text{conv}}]. \quad (210)$$

Thus the channel resource is an exact detector of conventional NHSE within the stated complete model class.

*Proof.* By Theorem 7,

$$A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H) > 0 \iff H^T \neq H. \quad (211)$$

By the defining property of the class  $\mathcal{C}$ ,

$$H^T \neq H \iff H \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{NHSE}}^{\text{conv}}. \quad (212)$$

Combining the two equivalences proves the result.  $\square$

**Remark 23** (Logical hierarchy). *The preceding results have three distinct logical strengths:*

$$H^T \neq H \implies A_{\diamond, \kappa}^{\text{sup}}(H; \mathcal{T}) > 0, \quad (213)$$

$$H \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{TR-NHSE}} \implies A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H) > 0, \quad (214)$$

$$H \in \mathcal{C}, \quad \mathcal{C} \text{ complete} \implies [A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H) > 0 \iff H \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{NHSE}}^{\text{conv}}]. \quad (215)$$

Equation (213) is universal within the finite-dimensional transpose-breaking channel architecture. Equation (214) is the one-way NHSE witness statement. Equation (215) is the class-conditional exact correspondence. No stronger universal NHSE equivalence is used elsewhere in the paper.

## IX. DIAGNOSTIC SECTOR I: NON-BLOCH SPECTRAL STRUCTURE

The channel QRT is the primitive theory. Spectral quantities below are structured Hamiltonian diagnostics, not additional free-operation monotones.

For a translation-invariant one-dimensional lattice,

$$H(\beta) = \sum_{r=-p}^q H_r \beta^r. \quad (216)$$

For a fixed energy  $E$ , let the roots of

$$\det[H(\beta) - E] = 0 \quad (217)$$

be ordered as

$$|\beta_1| \leq \dots \leq |\beta_{2M}|. \quad (218)$$

For nearest-neighbor  $M$ -channel models, the GBZ condition is

$$|\beta_M| = |\beta_{M+1}|. \quad (219)$$

**Definition 32** (GBZ radius witness). *Define*

$$\rho_{\text{GBZ}}(H) = \frac{1}{a} \sup_{\beta \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{GBZ}}} |\ln |\beta||. \quad (220)$$

**Lemma 7** (Reciprocal root pairing). *Consider a clean reciprocal nearest-neighbor chain with invertible intercell hopping blocks and*

$$H_{-1} = H_1^T, \quad H_0 = H_0^T. \quad (221)$$

Then

$$H(\beta)^T = H(\beta^{-1}), \quad (222)$$

and

$$\det[H(\beta) - E] = \det[H(\beta^{-1}) - E]. \quad (223)$$

Thus nonzero roots occur in reciprocal pairs

$$\boxed{\beta \leftrightarrow \beta^{-1}}. \quad (224)$$

*Proof.* Direct substitution gives

$$H(\beta)^T = H_{-1}^T \beta^{-1} + H_0^T + H_1^T \beta = H_1 \beta^{-1} + H_0 + H_{-1} \beta = H(\beta^{-1}). \quad (225)$$

Taking determinants proves the result.  $\square$

**Theorem 8** (Reciprocity forces zero determinant winding). *For a clean reciprocal chain and a reference energy  $E$  in a point gap,*

$$\boxed{W_{\text{BZ}}(E) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} dk \partial_k \log \det[H(k) - E] = 0.} \quad (226)$$

*Proof.* Reciprocity implies  $H(-k) = H(k)^T$ , hence

$$\det[H(-k) - E] = \det[H(k) - E]. \quad (227)$$

Thus the logarithmic derivative is odd on the Brillouin zone and the integral vanishes.  $\square$

**Corollary 6** (Reciprocal GBZ is the unit circle). *Under the hypotheses of Lemma 7,*

$$|\beta_M| = |\beta_{M+1}| = 1, \quad (228)$$

and therefore

$$\boxed{\rho_{\text{GBZ}} = 0}. \quad (229)$$

*Proof.* Reciprocal pairing gives

$$|\beta_j| |\beta_{2M+1-j}| = 1. \quad (230)$$

At the GBZ crossing, the two middle moduli are equal, so both are unity.  $\square$

**Proposition 19** (Hatano–Nelson spectral calibration). *For*

$$H_g(\beta) = m + Je^g\beta + Je^{-g}\beta^{-1}, \quad g \in \mathbb{R}, \quad (231)$$

*the two roots of  $H_g(\beta) = E$  satisfy*

$$\beta_1\beta_2 = e^{-2g}, \quad (232)$$

*and the scalar GBZ radius is*

$$\rho_{\text{GBZ}} = \frac{|g|}{a}. \quad (233)$$

*Proof.* Multiplying the characteristic equation by  $\beta$  gives a quadratic whose leading and constant coefficients differ by  $e^{\pm g}$ , so the product of its roots is  $e^{-2g}$ . The scalar GBZ condition forces equal root moduli and therefore  $|\beta_{\text{GBZ}}| = e^{-|g|}$ .  $\square$

## X. NECESSITY AND UNIFORM SHORT-TIME BRIDGE

**Assumption 1** (Clean finite-range class).  *$H$  is a one-dimensional translation-invariant finite-range single-particle Hamiltonian with internal dimension  $M$ . For GBZ root-pairing conclusions we additionally assume nearest-neighbor intercell blocks and their invertibility.*

**Definition 33** (Real-space reciprocity). *For a translation-invariant Hamiltonian,*

$$H_r = H_{-r}^T \quad \text{for all } r. \quad (234)$$

*Equivalently, the finite-size matrix satisfies  $H^T = H$  in the fixed spatial basis.*

**Corollary 7** (Reciprocity is a necessary obstruction to conventional reciprocal-breaking NHSE). *Within the clean class,*

$$H^T = H \implies A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}) = 0, \quad W_{\text{BZ}}(E) = 0, \quad (235)$$

*and under the nearest-neighbor assumptions,*

$$\rho_{\text{GBZ}} = 0. \quad (236)$$

*Therefore every conventional NHSE mechanism in the present transpose-reciprocity-breaking sector must satisfy*

$$\boxed{\text{conventional transpose-reciprocity-breaking NHSE} \implies \exists t : A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}) \neq 0.} \quad (237)$$

*Proof.* The channel statement follows from Proposition 4; the spectral statements follow from Sec. IX. The final implication follows from Theorem 7 on the stated sector.  $\square$

**Definition 34** (Transition-probability asymmetry defect).

$$D_{\text{amp}}(H) = \max_m \sum_{n \neq m} ||H_{nm}|^2 - |H_{mn}|^2|. \quad (238)$$

## A. Uniform thermodynamic short-time control

The thermodynamic short-time statement requires more than a pointwise expansion at each finite system size. To prevent the remainder from growing with  $L$ , the small-time estimate is formulated with an explicit system-size-independent bound.

**Assumption 2** (Uniformly bounded thermodynamic Hamiltonian family). *Let  $\{H_L\}_{L \geq 1}$  be a family of finite-dimensional Hamiltonians satisfying*

$$\sup_{L \geq 1} \|H_L\|_\infty \leq h < \infty. \quad (239)$$

*For the thermodynamic NHSE applications below, we additionally assume uniformly bounded finite interaction range.*

**Lemma 8** (Uniform exponential remainder for the propagator). *Under Assumption 2,*

$$U_L(t) = \mathbb{1} - iH_L t + R_L(t), \quad (240)$$

*with*

$$\|R_L(t)\|_\infty \leq \frac{1}{2} h^2 t^2 e^{ht} \quad (241)$$

*for every  $L$  and  $t \geq 0$ .*

*Proof.* Using the exponential series,

$$R_L(t) = \sum_{r=2}^{\infty} \frac{(-itH_L)^r}{r!}, \quad (242)$$

$$\|R_L(t)\|_\infty \leq \sum_{r=2}^{\infty} \frac{(ht)^r}{r!} \leq \frac{1}{2} h^2 t^2 e^{ht}. \quad (243)$$

The bound is independent of  $L$ .  $\square$

**Lemma 9** (Uniform short-time control of transition intensities). *Under Assumption 2, for every  $m$  and every  $t \geq 0$ ,*

$$\sum_{n \neq m} ||U_L(t)_{nm}|^2 - t^2 |(H_L)_{nm}|^2| \leq \mathcal{E}_h(t), \quad (244)$$

*and*

$$\sum_{n \neq m} ||U_L(t)_{mn}|^2 - t^2 |(H_L)_{mn}|^2| \leq \mathcal{E}_h(t), \quad (245)$$

*where*

$$\mathcal{E}_h(t) = h^3 t^3 e^{ht} + \frac{1}{4} h^4 t^4 e^{2ht}. \quad (246)$$

*Consequently,*

$$\max_m \sum_{n \neq m} ||U_L(t)_{nm}|^2 - |U_L(t)_{mn}|^2 - t^2 (|(H_L)_{nm}|^2 - |(H_L)_{mn}|^2)| \leq \dots \quad (247)$$

*All constants are independent of  $L$ .*

*Proof.* Write

$$U_L(t)_{nm} = -it(H_L)_{nm} + R_L(t)_{nm}. \quad (248)$$

Then

$$|U_L(t)_{nm}|^2 - t^2|(H_L)_{nm}|^2 \leq 2t|(H_L)_{nm}||R_L(t)_{nm}| + |R_L(t)_{nm}|^2. \quad (249)$$

Summing and using Cauchy–Schwarz gives

$$\sum_n 2t|(H_L)_{nm}||R_L(t)_{nm}| \leq 2t \left( \sum_n |(H_L)_{nm}|^2 \right)^{1/2} \left( \sum_n |R_L(t)_{nm}|^2 \right)^{1/2} \quad (250)$$

$$\leq 2th \|R_L(t)\|_\infty \quad (251)$$

$$\leq h^3 t^3 e^{ht}, \quad (252)$$

while

$$\sum_n |R_L(t)_{nm}|^2 \leq \|R_L(t)\|_\infty^2 \leq \frac{1}{4} h^4 t^4 e^{2ht}. \quad (253)$$

This proves the first estimate. The row estimate follows by applying the same argument to  $U_L(t)^\dagger$  and  $H_L^\dagger$ . Combining the two estimates gives the final inequality.  $\square$

**Proposition 20** (Uniform finite-size short-time resource lower bound). *Let  $\{H_L\}$  satisfy Assumption 2, and let  $\kappa_L(t)$  be an admissible scalar normalization gauge satisfying*

$$\kappa_L(t) = \kappa_0 + O(t) \quad (254)$$

*uniformly in  $L$ , with  $\kappa_0 > 0$ . Then there exist  $t_0 > 0$  and  $C_* > 0$ , independent of  $L$ , such that for all  $0 < t < t_0$ ,*

$$A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H_L,t}) \geq \frac{t^2}{2\kappa_0} D_{\text{amp}}(H_L) - C_* t^3. \quad (255)$$

*Thus the leading short-time lower-bound coefficient is uniform in system size.*

*Proof.* By Proposition 28,

$$A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H_L,t}) \geq \frac{1}{2\kappa_L(t)} \max_m \sum_n ||U_L(t)_{nm}|^2 - |U_L(t)_{mn}|^2|. \quad (256)$$

The diagonal term  $n = m$  vanishes identically. Hence Lemma 9 gives

$$\max_m \sum_{n \neq m} ||U_L(t)_{nm}|^2 - |U_L(t)_{mn}|^2| \geq t^2 D_{\text{amp}}(H_L) - 2\mathcal{E}_h(t). \quad (257)$$

Because

$$\kappa_L(t)^{-1} = \kappa_0^{-1} + O(t) \quad (258)$$

uniformly in  $L$ , and  $D_{\text{amp}}(H_L)$  is uniformly bounded for a finite-range uniformly bounded family, the normalization correction contributes only an  $L$ -independent  $O(t^3)$  term. The remainder  $2\mathcal{E}_h(t)$  is likewise  $O(t^3)$  uniformly in  $L$ . Collecting constants proves the stated lower bound.  $\square$

**Corollary 8** (Thermodynamic small-time lower bound). *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 20,*

$$\liminf_{t \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{A_{\diamond,\infty}(t)}{t^2} \geq \frac{1}{2\kappa_0} \limsup_{L \rightarrow \infty} D_{\text{amp}}(H_L). \quad (259)$$

*In particular, if*

$$\limsup_{L \rightarrow \infty} D_{\text{amp}}(H_L) > 0, \quad (260)$$

*the thermodynamic channel resource is strictly positive at sufficiently small nonzero times.*

*Proof.* From Proposition 20,

$$A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H_L,t}) \geq \frac{t^2}{2\kappa_0} D_{\text{amp}}(H_L) - C_* t^3. \quad (261)$$

Taking  $\limsup_{L \rightarrow \infty}$  gives

$$A_{\diamond,\infty}(t) \geq \frac{t^2}{2\kappa_0} \limsup_{L \rightarrow \infty} D_{\text{amp}}(H_L) - C_* t^3. \quad (262)$$

Divide by  $t^2$  and take  $\liminf_{t \rightarrow 0^+}$ .  $\square$

**Proposition 21** (Uniform thermodynamic persistence of the Hatano–Nelson channel resource). *Consider the open uniform Hatano–Nelson family*

$$H_{g,L} = m\mathbb{1} + J e^g T_+ + J e^{-g} T_-, \quad T_- = T_+^T, \quad (263)$$

*with fixed  $J > 0$ ,  $g \in \mathbb{R}$ , and system-independent  $m, J, g$ . Then*

$$\|H_{g,L}\|_\infty \leq |m| + 2J \cosh |g| =: h_g \quad (264)$$

*for every  $L$ . Moreover, for all  $L \geq 3$ ,*

$$D_{\text{amp}}(H_{g,L}) = 4J^2 \sinh(2|g|). \quad (265)$$

*Let the normalization satisfy*

$$\kappa_L(t) = \kappa_0 + O(t) \quad (266)$$

*uniformly in  $L$ , with  $\kappa_0 > 0$ . Then*

$$A_{\diamond,\infty}(t) \geq \frac{2J^2 \sinh(2|g|)}{\kappa_0} t^2 - C_g t^3 \quad (267)$$

*for sufficiently small  $t$ , where  $C_g$  is finite and independent of  $L$ . Consequently,*

$$\liminf_{t \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{A_{\diamond,\infty}(t)}{t^2} \geq \frac{2J^2 \sinh(2|g|)}{\kappa_0}. \quad (268)$$

*Hence, for every  $g \neq 0$ ,*

$$A_{\diamond,\infty}(t) > 0 \quad (269)$$

*for all sufficiently small  $t > 0$ .*

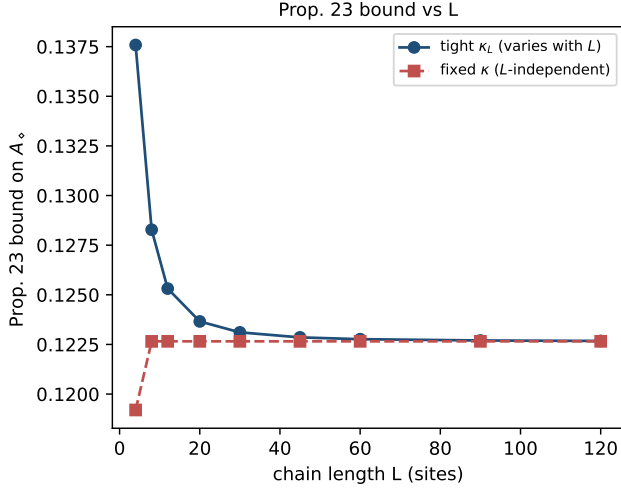


FIG. 2. Numerical evaluation of the finite- $t$  transition-amplitude bound of Proposition 28,  $\frac{1}{2} \max_m \sum_n |K(n, m)|^2 - |K(m, n)|^2$ , as a function of system size  $L$  for the uniform Hatano–Nelson family at  $g = 0.5$  and  $t = 0.35$ , with the normalization  $\kappa_L = 1.05 \|U_{H_{g,L}}(t)\|_\infty^2$  (the form of Remark 25 with  $\varepsilon_0 = 0.05$ , evaluated at  $t = 0.35$  rather than in the limit  $t \rightarrow 0^+$ , so  $\kappa_L$  itself varies with  $L$ , from 1.98 at  $L = 4$  to 2.286 at  $L = 120$ ). This is not the  $O(t^2)$  expression of Proposition 20. The blue curve (tight  $\kappa_L$ ) decreases from 0.1376 at  $L = 4$  to  $\approx 0.1227$  at  $L = 120$ , but this decrease is a normalization effect; the red dashed curve uses one  $L$ -independent  $\kappa = 2.2865$  (evaluated at  $L = 200$ ) and rises from 0.1192 at  $L = 4$  to 0.12265 at  $L = 8$ , constant to six digits for all  $L \geq 12$ . At that  $\kappa$  the leading short-time term of Proposition 20,  $t^2 D_{\text{amp}}/(2\kappa)$ , equals 0.1259, within 3% of the plateau. The blue-curve decrease is a normalization effect: the un-normalized numerator  $\kappa_L \times (\text{bound})$  equals 0.2726 at  $L = 4$  and 0.2805 (unchanged to four digits) for every tested  $L \geq 8$ , so the entire  $L$ -dependence of the curve comes from  $\kappa_L$ . The figure therefore does not by itself test spatial locality; the  $L$ -uniform content is the saturation of the numerator from  $L = 8$  on, which is consistent with the  $L$ -uniform structure of Corollary 8. It is a consistency check at a single  $(g, t)$ , not a verification of the small- $t$  asymptotics or of the thermodynamic limit.

*Proof.* Because  $\|T_\pm\|_\infty = 1$ ,

$$\|H_{g,L}\|_\infty \leq |m| + Je^g + Je^{-g} \quad (270)$$

$$= |m| + 2J \cosh |g|, \quad (271)$$

uniformly in  $L$ . For a bulk site  $m$ , the two neighboring bonds contribute

$$|H_{m+1,m}|^2 - |H_{m,m+1}|^2 = J^2 |e^{2g} - e^{-2g}|, \quad (272)$$

$$|H_{m-1,m}|^2 - |H_{m,m-1}|^2 = J^2 |e^{2g} - e^{-2g}|. \quad (273)$$

Thus, for  $L \geq 3$ ,

$$D_{\text{amp}}(H_{g,L}) = 2J^2 |e^{2g} - e^{-2g}| \quad (274)$$

$$= 4J^2 \sinh(2|g|). \quad (275)$$

The result follows from Corollary 8.  $\square$

**Remark 24** (What is actually uniform in the thermodynamic limit). *The preceding proposition is stronger than a pointwise finite-size expansion. The coefficient of  $t^2$  is independent of  $L$ , and the remainder is controlled by a constant depending only on the uniform Hamiltonian bound and the normalization gauge. Thus the statement  $A_{\diamond,\infty}(t) > 0$  at sufficiently small nonzero  $t$  is not obtained by assuming that a finite-size error remains bounded in the thermodynamic limit; the  $L$ -uniform bound is established explicitly.*

**Remark 25** (Tight normalization in the Hatano–Nelson family). *For the per-Hamiltonian tight normalization,*

$$\kappa_{H_{g,L}}^{\text{tight}}(t) = (1 + \varepsilon_0) \|U_{H_{g,L}}(t)\|_\infty^2, \quad (276)$$

one has

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0^+} \kappa_{H_{g,L}}^{\text{tight}}(t) = 1 + \varepsilon_0 \quad (277)$$

uniformly in  $L$ . Hence

$$\boxed{\kappa_0 = 1 + \varepsilon_0} \quad (278)$$

and

$$\boxed{\liminf_{t \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{A_{\diamond,\infty}(t)}{t^2} \geq \frac{2J^2 \sinh(2|g|)}{1 + \varepsilon_0}}. \quad (279)$$

## XI. MULTICHANNEL SHARPNESS: WINDING CANCELLATION

**Proposition 22** (Winding-cancellation skin counterexample). *Let*

$$H_{\oplus,g}(k) = H_g(k) \oplus H_{-g}(k), \quad g \neq 0. \quad (280)$$

*Then the two decoupled sectors have opposite conventional skin accumulation, while*

$$\boxed{W_{\oplus,g}(E) = 0} \quad (281)$$

*for every reference energy in a common point gap. At nontrivial times away from exact reciprocal points,*

$$A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H_{\oplus,g}) > 0. \quad (282)$$

*Proof.* Each block is a Hatano–Nelson chain, with right eigenvectors related to reciprocal standing waves by opposite diagonal similarity transforms. Thus the two sectors accumulate at opposite boundaries. Since  $H_{-g}(k) = H_g(-k)$ , their determinant winding numbers cancel:

$$W_{\oplus,g}(E) = W_g(E) + W_{-g}(E) = 0. \quad (283)$$

For  $g \neq 0$ , the direct-sum Hamiltonian is not transpose reciprocal in the fixed block basis, so Theorem 7 gives positive trajectory-derived channel resource.  $\square$

**Remark 26.** *This construction shows why the channel resource should not be identified with a single scalar determinant winding integer. The statement is relative to the untwisted reciprocity frame: in the spin-flip-twisted frame of Remark 28 the same channel is reciprocal and the resource vanishes, so this example does not by itself show detection of skin physics that a scalar winding misses in a physically fixed frame.*

## XII. DIAGNOSTIC SECTOR II: DISORDERED LYAPUNOV STRUCTURE

**Definition 35** (Transfer cocycle and Lyapunov exponents). *Let*

$$\Psi_{n+1} = T_n(E)\Psi_n, \quad T^{(N)} = T_N \cdots T_1. \quad (284)$$

*If the limits exist and*

$$s_1(T^{(N)}) \geq \cdots \geq s_{2M}(T^{(N)}), \quad (285)$$

*define*

$$\gamma_j(E) = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{Na} \ln s_j(T^{(N)}). \quad (286)$$

**Proposition 23** (Boundary invariance of Lyapunov spectrum). *If*

$$T'^{(N)} = A_{\partial} T^{(N)} B_{\partial} \quad (287)$$

*with uniformly bounded invertible endpoint matrices, then*

$$\gamma'_j(E) = \gamma_j(E). \quad (288)$$

*Proof.* Uniformly bounded endpoint factors modify each singular value only by multiplicative constants independent of  $N$ . Dividing the logarithm by  $Na$  removes these constants.  $\square$

**Lemma 10** (Symplectic singular-value pairing). *Let*

$$J = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \mathbb{1}_M \\ -\mathbb{1}_M & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad (289)$$

*and suppose  $S$  obeys*

$$S^T J S = J. \quad (290)$$

*Then*

$$\sigma_j(S) \sigma_{2M+1-j}(S) = 1. \quad (291)$$

*Proof.* From  $S^T J S = J$ ,

$$S^{-1} = -J S^T J. \quad (292)$$

Since  $J$  is unitary and transpose preserves singular values,  $S^{-1}$  has the same singular values as  $S$ . The singular values of  $S^{-1}$  are  $1/\sigma_{2M}, \dots, 1/\sigma_1$ .  $\square$

**Theorem 9** (Reciprocity-induced Lyapunov pairing). *Let*

$$H_{n,n+1} = t_n^T, \quad H_{n+1,n} = t_n, \quad H_{n,n} = m_n, \quad (293)$$

*with*

$$m_n^T = m_n, \quad \sup_n \|t_n\| < \infty, \quad \sup_n \|t_n^{-1}\| < \infty. \quad (294)$$

*Assume, in addition, that the Lyapunov limits in Definition 35 exist. Then*

$$\gamma_j(E) = -\gamma_{2M+1-j}(E). \quad (295)$$

*Proof.* Write  $\Psi_n = (\chi_n, \chi_{n-1})$ . The eigen-equation gives

$$t_n^T \chi_{n+1} = (E - m_n) \chi_n - t_{n-1} \chi_{n-1}, \quad (296)$$

and hence

$$T_n = \begin{pmatrix} (t_n^T)^{-1}(E - m_n) & -(t_n^T)^{-1}t_{n-1} \\ \mathbb{1} & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (297)$$

The bilinear Wronskian

$$\mathcal{W}_n(\psi, \phi) = \psi_n^T t_n^T \phi_{n+1} - \phi_n^T t_n^T \psi_{n+1} \quad (298)$$

is independent of  $n$ . Therefore

$$T_n^T \Omega_{n+1} T_n = \Omega_n, \quad \Omega_n = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -t_{n-1} \\ t_{n-1}^T & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (299)$$

With

$$P_n = \text{diag}(\mathbb{1}, -t_{n-1}), \quad (300)$$

we have

$$P_n^T J P_n = \Omega_n, \quad (301)$$

so

$$\tilde{T}_n = P_{n+1} T_n P_n^{-1} \quad (302)$$

is symplectic. Lemma 10 gives singular-value pairing for products, while the uniformly bounded endpoint factors do not alter the Lyapunov limits.  $\square$

**Definition 36** (Imaginary-gauge spatial excess). *Suppose a reciprocal disordered backbone has Lyapunov spectrum*

$$\left\{ \pm \frac{L_j(E)}{a} \right\}_{j=1}^M, \quad 0 \leq L_1(E) \leq \cdots \leq L_M(E), \quad (303)$$

*and the nonreciprocal member is generated by*

$$H_{g,\omega} = S_g H_{0,\omega} S_g^{-1}, \quad S_g |n\rangle = e^{-gn} |n\rangle. \quad (304)$$

*Define*

$$R_{\text{Lyap}}^{\text{skin}}(H_g; \mathcal{E}) = \frac{1}{a} \sup_{E \in \mathcal{E}} [|g| - L_1(E)]_+. \quad (305)$$

**Proposition 24** (Clean Lyapunov–GBZ correspondence). *For a clean constant transfer matrix with nondegenerate diagonalizable spectrum,*

$$T = V \text{diag}(\beta_1^\downarrow, \dots, \beta_{2M}^\downarrow) V^{-1}, \quad |\beta_1^\downarrow| \geq \dots \geq |\beta_{2M}^\downarrow|, \quad (306)$$

one has

$$\gamma_j(E) = \frac{1}{a} \ln |\beta_j^\downarrow(E)|. \quad (307)$$

Thus

$$|\beta_M| = |\beta_{M+1}| \iff \gamma_M = \gamma_{M+1}. \quad (308)$$

*Proof.* The diagonalizable eigenvector factors contribute only  $O(1)$  to the logarithms of singular values of  $T^N$ , while the diagonal powers contribute  $N \ln |\beta_j|$ .  $\square$

### XIII. DIAGNOSTIC SECTOR III: BOUNDARY CONCENTRATION

Let normalized right eigenvectors be  $|\psi_{a,L}^R\rangle$  and define

$$p_{a,L}(n) = \frac{\sum_\alpha |\langle n, \alpha | \psi_{a,L}^R \rangle|^2}{\sum_{m,\alpha} |\langle m, \alpha | \psi_{a,L}^R \rangle|^2}. \quad (309)$$

**Definition 37** (Edge concentration). *For an extensive spectral window  $I$  and boundary thickness  $\ell$ ,*

$$C_I^L(L, \ell) = \frac{1}{N_I(L)} \sum_{a \in I} \sum_{n=1}^{\ell} p_{a,L}(n), \quad (310)$$

$$C_I^R(L, \ell) = \frac{1}{N_I(L)} \sum_{a \in I} \sum_{n=L-\ell+1}^L p_{a,L}(n), \quad (311)$$

and

$$C_I^{\text{edge}} = \max\{C_I^L, C_I^R\}, \quad \Delta_I^{\text{edge}} = |C_I^L - C_I^R|. \quad (312)$$

*Conventional extensive skin accumulation means that there exists  $\ell_L = o(L)$  such that*

$$\limsup_{L \rightarrow \infty} C_I^{\text{edge}}(L, \ell_L) > 0. \quad (313)$$

**Definition 38** (Collective decay profile). *For edge  $\epsilon \in \{L, R\}$ , let  $P_I^\epsilon(r)$  denote the thermodynamic averaged eigenstate intensity at distance  $r$  from that edge, whenever the limit exists, and set*

$$G_I^\epsilon(r) = -\ln \frac{P_I^\epsilon(r)}{P_I^\epsilon(0)}. \quad (314)$$

**Definition 39** (Scale-resolved spatial witness). *For a reference function  $f(r) \rightarrow \infty$ ,*

$$R_f^{(I,\epsilon)}(H) = \limsup_{r \rightarrow \infty} \frac{G_I^\epsilon(r)}{f(r)}. \quad (315)$$

**Theorem 10** (Lyapunov blindness to subexponential profiles). *If*

$$G(r) \rightarrow \infty, \quad \frac{G(r)}{r} \rightarrow 0, \quad (316)$$

then

$$\limsup_{r \rightarrow \infty} \frac{G(r)}{r} = 0. \quad (317)$$

*Thus a vanishing linear decay coefficient does not imply absence of edge concentration.*

*Proof.* The conclusion is immediate from the asymptotic assumption. Edge concentration is an integrated spatial property, whereas the linear coefficient only measures one asymptotic scale.  $\square$

**Proposition 25** (Stability under finite-depth local unitary processing). *Let  $V_L$  be a depth- $d$  local unitary circuit with gate range  $r_0$ , independent of  $L$ . A boundary projector supported on width  $\ell$  is mapped to an operator supported within width  $\ell + O(dr_0)$ . Hence an extensive edge-concentration criterion is stable under such processing up to a subextensive change of boundary thickness.*

*Proof.* Each circuit layer enlarges the support of a boundary observable by at most the gate range. After  $d$  layers the enlargement is  $O(dr_0)$ .  $\square$

### XIV. DIAGNOSTIC SECTOR IV: DYNAMICAL CHANNEL SIGNATURES

For a localized input,

$$P_t(n|m) = \frac{|U_H(t)_{nm}|^2}{\sum_r |U_H(t)_{rm}|^2}. \quad (318)$$

**Definition 40** (Localized reflection asymmetry). *For a site  $m$  sufficiently far from boundaries so that the reflection  $n \mapsto 2m - n$  is defined on the relevant support, let*

$$(\mathcal{R}_m P)(n|m) = P(2m - n|m). \quad (319)$$

Define

$$D(t; m) = \frac{1}{2} \|P_t(\cdot|m) - \mathcal{R}_m P_t(\cdot|m)\|_1. \quad (320)$$

**Definition 41** (Dynamical witnesses). *Define*

$$R_{\text{dyn}}^{\text{max}}(H) = \sup_{t>0} \sup_m D(t; m), \quad (321)$$

and

$$R_{\text{dyn}}^\infty(H) = \limsup_{t \rightarrow \infty} \sup_m D(t; m). \quad (322)$$

*These are operational witnesses, not QRT monotones.*

**Proposition 26** (Dynamical gauge embedding). *Let*

$$H_g = S_g H_0 S_g^{-1}, \quad S_g |n\rangle = e^{-gn} |n\rangle, \quad H_0^T = H_0. \quad (323)$$

*Then*

$$U_g(t) = S_g U_0(t) S_g^{-1}, \quad (324)$$

*and whenever the denominator is nonzero,*

$$\frac{U_g(t)_{nm}}{U_g(t)_{mn}} = e^{-2g(n-m)}. \quad (325)$$

*Thus*

$$a_{\text{dyn}}(t; r) = \frac{1}{2r} \ln \left| \frac{U_g(t)_{r0}}{U_g(t)_{0r}} \right| = -g \quad (326)$$

*whenever the ratio is defined.*

*Proof.* The similarity relation and  $U_0(t)^T = U_0(t)$  imply

$$\frac{U_g(t)_{nm}}{U_g(t)_{mn}} = \frac{e^{-g(n-m)} U_0(t)_{nm}}{e^{g(n-m)} U_0(t)_{mn}} = e^{-2g(n-m)}. \quad (327)$$

□

**Proposition 27** (Reciprocal stochastic post-processing contracts dynamical asymmetry). *Let  $K_t$  be a stochastic kernel commuting with reflection around  $m$ . Then*

$$D(K_t P_t) \leq D(P_t). \quad (328)$$

*Proof.* Use  $\ell^1$  contractivity:

$$D(K_t P_t) = \frac{1}{2} \|K_t(P_t - \mathcal{R}_m P_t)\|_1 \leq \frac{1}{2} \|P_t - \mathcal{R}_m P_t\|_1. \quad (329)$$

□

**Proposition 28** (Operational lower bound from transition amplitudes). *For the Julia-dilated channel,*

$$A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}) \geq \frac{1}{2} \max_m \sum_n \left| |K_{H,t}(n, m)|^2 - |K_{H,t}(m, n)|^2 \right|. \quad (330)$$

*Proof.* Prepare the physical input  $|m\rangle\langle m|$  and perform the projective measurement whose outcomes include the physical-sector site states. Under  $\mathcal{N}_{H,t}$  the corresponding physical-site probabilities are  $|K_{H,t}(n, m)|^2$ , while under  $\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{\text{rev}}$  they are  $|K_{H,t}(m, n)|^2$ . Data processing for trace distance and the defining optimization of the diamond norm yield the stated bound. □

**Proposition 29** (Finite-range weighted propagation bound). *Let  $H$  be bounded and finite range. Let the position operator satisfy*

$$X|n, \alpha\rangle = n|n, \alpha\rangle. \quad (331)$$

*For  $\mu > 0$ , define*

$$J_{\sigma\mu} = \|e^{\sigma\mu X} H e^{-\sigma\mu X}\|_\infty, \quad \sigma = \pm 1. \quad (332)$$

*Then*

$$|U_H(t)_{nm}| \leq \begin{cases} \exp[J_{+\mu} t - \mu(n-m)], & n \geq m, \\ \exp[J_{-\mu} t - \mu(m-n)], & n < m. \end{cases} \quad (333)$$

*Hence*

$$|U_H(t)_{nm}| \leq \exp[-\mu|n-m| + J_\mu^* t], \quad J_\mu^* = \max\{J_{+\mu}, J_{-\mu}\}. \quad (334)$$

*Proof.* Conjugating the exponential by  $e^{\sigma\mu X}$  and taking operator norms gives

$$\|e^{\sigma\mu X} U_H(t) e^{-\sigma\mu X}\|_\infty \leq e^{J_{\sigma\mu} t}. \quad (335)$$

Taking matrix elements yields the result. □

## XV. EXACT HATANO–NELSON/RESOURCE EQUIVALENCE

**Proposition 30** (Transpose-reciprocity completeness of the uniform Hatano–Nelson family). *Consider the thermodynamic uniform Hatano–Nelson family*

$$H_{g,L} = m\mathbb{1} + J e^g T_+ + J e^{-g} T_-, \quad T_- = T_+^T, \quad J > 0. \quad (336)$$

*Then*

$$H_{g,L}^T = H_{g,L} \iff g = 0. \quad (337)$$

*Moreover, for  $g \neq 0$ ,*

$$\rho_{\text{GBZ}} = \frac{|g|}{a} > 0, \quad (338)$$

*and the OBC right eigenvectors obey*

$$\psi_{j,g}(n) \propto e^{-gn} \sin\left(\frac{\pi j n}{L+1}\right). \quad (339)$$

*Thus conventional OBC skin accumulation occurs for every fixed  $g \neq 0$ . Consequently, the uniform Hatano–Nelson family is transpose-reciprocity complete with respect to conventional NHSE:*

$$g \neq 0 \iff H_{g,L}^T \neq H_{g,L} \iff \rho_{\text{GBZ}} > 0 \iff \text{conventional OBC}. \quad (340)$$

*Proof.* The transpose exchanges the two nonreciprocal hopping amplitudes:

$$H_{g,L}^T = m\mathbb{1} + J e^{-g} T_+ + J e^g T_-. \quad (341)$$

Therefore

$$H_{g,L}^T = H_{g,L} \iff e^g = e^{-g} \iff g = 0. \quad (342)$$

The GBZ result follows from Proposition 19. For open boundaries,

$$H_{g,L} = S_g H_{0,L} S_g^{-1}, \quad S_g |n\rangle = e^{-gn} |n\rangle, \quad (343)$$

so right eigenvectors are obtained from reciprocal standing-wave eigenvectors by the exponential gauge factor  $e^{-gn}$ . Hence  $g > 0$  produces left-edge accumulation,  $g < 0$  produces right-edge accumulation, and  $g = 0$  gives the reciprocal extended limit. This establishes the equivalence.  $\square$

**Corollary 9** (Exact trajectory-level NHSE/resource equivalence for uniform Hatano–Nelson). *Assume the operational time domain is  $(0, \infty)$  and use the tight normalization of Definition 23. Then*

$$A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H_g) > 0 \iff g \neq 0 \iff \rho_{\text{GBZ}} > 0 \iff \text{conventional OBC NHSE} \quad (344)$$

Moreover, for every  $g \neq 0$ ,

$$\liminf_{t \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{A_{\diamond, \infty}(t)}{t^2} \geq \frac{2J^2 \sinh(2|g|)}{1 + \varepsilon_0} > 0. \quad (345)$$

*Proof.* The first line follows by combining Proposition 30 with Theorem 7. The thermodynamic bound is Proposition 21 with  $\kappa_0 = 1 + \varepsilon_0$ .  $\square$

**Remark 27** (Scope of the exact Hatano–Nelson theorem). *Corollary 9 is an exact solved subtheory. Its biconditional NHSE statement relies on the fact that, within the uniform Hatano–Nelson family, conventional OBC skin accumulation is equivalent to transpose-reciprocity breaking. The theorem is therefore not a claim that  $A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}} > 0$  is a universal detector of every possible NHSE mechanism.*

**Remark 28** (Frame dependence of the multichannel example). *The following proposition, like Proposition 22 of Sec. XI, is a statement in the untwisted reciprocity frame. Let  $\Sigma = \sigma_x$  swap the two species in  $H_{\oplus, g} = H_g \oplus H_{-g}$ . Since  $H_g^T = H_{-g}$ , one has  $H_{\oplus, g}^T = \Sigma H_{\oplus, g} \Sigma^\dagger$ , and likewise  $\Sigma K^T \Sigma^\dagger = K$  for  $K = K_{\oplus}$ . Because  $D_{\Sigma A \Sigma^\dagger} = \Sigma D_A \Sigma^\dagger$ ,*

$$\tilde{\Sigma} \tilde{U}_K^T \tilde{\Sigma}^\dagger = \tilde{U}_{\Sigma K^T \Sigma^\dagger} = \tilde{U}_K, \quad \tilde{\Sigma} = \Sigma \oplus \Sigma. \quad (346)$$

*The channel is thus reciprocal for the twisted transpose  $X \mapsto \tilde{\Sigma} X^T \tilde{\Sigma}^\dagger$  (an involution because  $\Sigma$  is real symmetric), a time reversal with an internal partner of the spin-flip type used in the symmetry classes that host  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  skin effects [9]. In that frame the resource vanishes although the two sectors accumulate at opposite edges. The example therefore shows that the resource is positive relative to the untwisted frame while the scalar winding cancels; it does not show detection of skin physics that a scalar winding misses in a physically fixed frame. Such twisted involutions can be accommodated as additional covariance data in the sense of Sec. XIX, but that is not done here.*

**Proposition 31** (Multichannel cancellation does not invalidate the scope theorem). *For the direct-sum family*

$$H_{\oplus, g}(k) = H_g(k) \oplus H_{-g}(k), \quad g \neq 0, \quad (347)$$

*the determinant winding may vanish,*

$$W_{\oplus, g}(E) = 0, \quad (348)$$

*while*

$$H_{\oplus, g}^T \neq H_{\oplus, g} \quad (349)$$

*and therefore*

$$A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H_{\oplus, g}) > 0. \quad (350)$$

*Thus the channel resource detects transpose-reciprocity breaking even when a single determinant-winding scalar cancels between channels.*

*Proof.* The opposite Hatano–Nelson sectors contribute opposite determinant windings, so the total winding cancels. However,

$$H_{\oplus, g}^T = H_{-g} \oplus H_g \neq H_g \oplus H_{-g} = H_{\oplus, g} \quad (351)$$

for  $g \neq 0$  in the fixed channel basis. Theorem 7 therefore yields positive trajectory-derived resource.  $\square$

## XVI. EXTENSIVE CELLULAR RESOURCE

The following extensive construction is deliberately formulated at the level of independent channel subsystems. A direct-sum single-particle Hamiltonian does not in general produce a tensor product of Julia channels under a single global normalization, so no such identification is made.

**Definition 42** (Cellular channel array). *A cellular array consists of independent cell subsystems with primitive channel objects  $\mathcal{N}_{c_1}, \dots, \mathcal{N}_{c_n}$  and composite channel*

$$\mathcal{N} = \bigotimes_{k=1}^n \mathcal{N}_{c_k}. \quad (352)$$

*If each cell object is generated by a Hamiltonian  $H_{c_k}$ , its own normalization gauge and canonical Julia completion are used before tensor-product assembly. This tensor-product assembly is an operational cellular construction and is not identified with the Julia channel obtained by applying one global normalization to a single-particle direct-sum Hamiltonian.*

**Definition 43** (Spatially local free superchannel). *A free superchannel on the cellular array is spatially local if*

$$\Theta = \bigotimes_{k=1}^n \Theta_k, \quad \Theta_k \in \mathfrak{D}_L. \quad (353)$$

*Denote this subclass by  $\mathfrak{D}_{\text{loc}}$ .*

**Remark 29.** *This is a strict cellwise locality class. More general finite-depth, bounded-range superchannels would require an explicit rule for how the spatial partition is transformed and how inter-cell memories are treated.*

**Definition 44** (Block-additive fixed-time resource). *For*

$$\mathcal{N} = \bigotimes_{k=1}^n \mathcal{N}_k, \quad (354)$$

define

$$E_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}) = \sum_{k=1}^n A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_k), \quad (355)$$

and

$$E_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}) = \sum_{k=1}^n R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}_k). \quad (356)$$

**Theorem 11** (Extensivity and local monotonicity). *For every spatially local free superchannel,*

$$E_{\diamond}(\Theta(\mathcal{N})) \leq E_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}), \quad E_{\text{rob}}(\Theta(\mathcal{N})) \leq E_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}). \quad (357)$$

*For a homogeneous array of  $n$  identical cells with  $A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_c) = a > 0$ ,*

$$E_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}) = na. \quad (358)$$

*Proof.* Apply the fixed-time monotonicity theorem to each cell and sum.  $\square$

**Definition 45** (Time-optimized block-additive resource). *For a collection of independent cell Hamiltonians  $\{H_{c_k}\}_{k=1}^n$ , define*

$$E_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}} = \sum_{k=1}^n A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H_{c_k}), \quad E_{\text{rob}}^{\text{sup}} = \sum_{k=1}^n R_{\text{rob}}^{\text{sup}}(H_{c_k}). \quad (359)$$

**Theorem 12** (Trajectory-derived extensivity and rescaling invariance). *Under cellwise free trajectory transformations,*

$$E_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(\mathfrak{f}\mathfrak{N}) \leq E_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(\mathfrak{N}). \quad (360)$$

*and similarly for  $E_{\text{rob}}^{\text{sup}}$ . Moreover  $E_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}$  is additive under independent cell concatenation and invariant under a common positive energy rescaling of all cell Hamiltonians.*

*Proof.* Apply trajectory-level monotonicity and tight-gauge energy-rescaling invariance to every cell, then sum.  $\square$

**Theorem 13** (Complete witness on the Hatano–Nelson gauge sector). *Let every cell object be drawn from a Hatano–Nelson gauge orbit. Then*

$$E_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}} > 0 \iff \text{at least one cell has } A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}} > 0. \quad (361)$$

*For a cell that is itself a thermodynamic uniform Hatano–Nelson family, Corollary 9 identifies this positivity with conventional OBC skin accumulation in that cell family.*

*Proof.* The sum is nonnegative, so it is positive exactly when at least one summand is positive. The Hatano–Nelson identification follows from Corollary 9.  $\square$

**Remark 30** (Scope of the extensive extension). *The quantity  $E_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}$  is an operationally extensive resource under explicitly cellwise local free operations. It should not be confused with an intrinsic tensor-power rate of the global single-particle QRT, which collapses by Proposition 7. Nor does a finite cell by itself constitute a thermodynamic NHSE system; the conventional NHSE interpretation applies when that factor is a thermodynamic cell family.*

## XVII. TOWARD SUFFICIENCY: AN EXPLICIT OBSTRUCTION AND A CONJECTURAL ATTENUATION PROTOCOL

Corollary 4 and Theorem 6 together give a necessary condition and a no-go result on the calibration orbit, but no sufficiency statement: we do not know whether  $\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*} \succeq_{\mathfrak{D}} \mathcal{N}_{g',\tau_*}$  actually holds for  $|g| > |g'|$  in the full ancilla-assisted class. This section isolates precisely what is already known, exhibits an explicit obstruction that rules out the most naive candidate protocol, and states the remaining gap as two concrete conjectures.

### A. What is already solved: resource-value sufficiency

Proposition 16 already shows that *some* channel realizing any prescribed smaller resource value is always reachable: for  $\mathcal{N} = \mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}$  and any  $a' \in [0, A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*})]$ , choosing  $p = a'/A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*})$  and  $\mathcal{R}_0 \in \mathfrak{F}_L$  arbitrary gives a free superchannel  $\Theta_p$  with  $A_{\diamond}(\Theta_p(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*})) = a'$ . We record this explicitly because it is easy to conflate with the open problem below, and it is not:  $\Theta_p(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*})$  is, for generic  $\mathcal{R}_0$ , not itself a Julia-dilated Hatano–Nelson calibration channel at all, let alone  $\mathcal{N}_{g',\tau_*}$  for the specific  $g'$  with  $A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_{g',\tau_*}) = a'$ . Matching the scalar monotone is therefore a strictly weaker goal than the one that matters physically: converting one calibration point into another.

**Definition 46** (Orbit-restricted convertibility). *Fix  $g$  and  $g'$  with  $0 \leq |g'| \leq |g| \leq g_{\text{max}}$  on the common-normalization domain of Theorem 5. We say the calibration is orbit-sufficient at  $(g, g')$  if there exists a finite-size*

free superchannel  $\Theta \in \mathfrak{D}_L$  (ancilla-assisted, of any finite ancilla dimension) such that

$$\Theta(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}) = \mathcal{N}_{g',\tau_*} \quad (362)$$

exactly, as opposed to merely  $A_\diamond(\Theta(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*})) = A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}_{g',\tau_*})$ .

### B. An explicit obstruction: the naive gauge-similarity map is not physical

The gauge family itself is generated by the non-unitary similarity  $H_g = S_g H_0 S_g^{-1}$ ,  $S_g = \text{diag}(1, e^{-g})$ , and the same similarity acts correctly at the level of the contraction  $K_g$ : a direct computation shows that conjugating  $K_g$  by  $S_\delta$  shifts the gauge parameter exactly,  $S_\delta K_g S_\delta^{-1} \propto K_{g+\delta}$  entrywise. It is therefore tempting to look for a free superchannel built directly from this similarity. The next proposition shows that the literal similarity map itself is not a quantum channel. This rules out that direct construction, but does not exclude more elaborate completely positive constructions that modify or embed the similarity before producing the desired channel transformation.

**Proposition 32** (Non-physicality of scalar gauge conjugation). *Let  $S_\delta = \text{diag}(1, e^{-\delta})$  on the two-site space,  $\delta \neq 0$  real, and define*

$$S_\delta(X) = S_\delta X S_\delta^{-1}. \quad (363)$$

*Then  $S_\delta$  does not map density matrices to density matrices: there exists a rank-one density matrix  $\rho$  for which  $S_\delta(\rho)$  is not Hermitian.*

*Proof.* Take  $\rho = |\psi\rangle\langle\psi|$  with  $|\psi\rangle = (|1\rangle + |2\rangle)/\sqrt{2}$ , so  $\rho = \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$ . With  $S_\delta = \text{diag}(1, e^{-\delta})$ ,  $S_\delta^{-1} = \text{diag}(1, e^\delta)$ ,

$$S_\delta(\rho) = \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & e^\delta \\ e^{-\delta} & 1 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (364)$$

This real matrix is symmetric, and hence Hermitian, if and only if  $e^\delta = e^{-\delta}$ , i.e.  $\delta = 0$ . For  $\delta \neq 0$  it is not Hermitian and therefore not a density matrix.  $\square$

**Remark 31** (What the obstruction rules out, and what it does not). *Proposition 32 rules out only the single most naive candidate: implementing the gauge shift by literal conjugation with the (non-unitary, non-isometric) matrix that algebraically defines the Hatano–Nelson family. It does not rule out the existence of a genuinely completely positive, trace-preserving realization of the same net effect on  $K_g$ . In particular, Theorem 6 constrains only the subclass  $\mathfrak{D}_{\text{uc}}(L)$  of unitary-congruence superchannels  $\Theta_V$ ; it says nothing about the strictly larger class of non-unitary reciprocal sandwiching maps  $\Theta_\Gamma(\mathcal{N}) = \Gamma^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{N} \circ \Gamma$  of Proposition 15, which requires only  $\Gamma \in \text{Obj}_L$  (no unitarity), nor about fully ancilla-assisted superchannels with*

*a joint Stinespring dilation. The obstruction therefore sharpens, rather than closes, the search: any successful attenuation protocol must act on the channel through its Julia-dilated, genuinely CP structure – e.g. through the nonlinear dependence of the defect operators  $D_K, D_{K^\dagger}$  on  $K$  – and not through a direct transplant of the algebraic gauge similarity used merely to define the Hamiltonian family.*

### C. Conjectures

**Conjecture 1** (Orbit-restricted sufficiency). *For every  $g, g'$  with  $0 \leq |g'| \leq |g| \leq g_{\text{max}}$  on the common-normalization domain, the calibration is orbit-sufficient at  $(g, g')$  in the sense of Definition 46, using a superchannel  $\Theta \in \mathfrak{D}_L$  with an ancilla of dimension bounded uniformly in  $g, g'$  (e.g.  $\dim E \leq 4$ , matching the dimension of the Julia space itself).*

A weaker, more tractable stepping stone concerns attenuation by an infinitesimal amount, where a perturbative construction might be found even if the global statement resists direct attack.

**Conjecture 2** (Infinitesimal sufficiency). *For every  $g \in (0, g_{\text{max}})$  there exists  $\eta_0 > 0$  and a smooth family  $\{\Theta_\eta\}_{\eta \in [0, \eta_0]} \subset \mathfrak{D}_L$ , with  $\Theta_0 = \text{id}$ , such that*

$$\Theta_\eta(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}) = \mathcal{N}_{g-\eta,\tau_*} \quad \text{for all } \eta \in [0, \eta_0]. \quad (365)$$

Conjecture 2 is the natural infinitesimal form of Conjecture 1, and proving it would amount to showing that the tangent direction  $-\partial_g \mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}$  at  $g$  lies in the tangent cone, at  $\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}$ , of the orbit  $\{\Theta(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}) : \Theta \in \mathfrak{D}_L\}$  of free superchannels. We do not carry out this tangent-space analysis here; it requires characterizing the local structure of  $\mathfrak{D}_L$  near the identity superchannel acting on a fixed channel, which is a nontrivial infinite-dimensional (in the ancilla dimension) feasibility question even in its linearized form.

**Remark 32** (A concrete numerical test). *At fixed finite ancilla dimension  $d_E$ , the orbit-conversion problem can in principle be posed as a semidefinite feasibility problem using the Choi operator of the complete superchannel, with its linear CPTP/causality constraints, together with the linear covariance constraint*

$$\Theta(\mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}) = [\Theta(\mathcal{N})]^{\text{rev}} \quad (366)$$

*and the linear output constraint for a fixed input channel*

$$\Theta(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}) = \mathcal{N}_{g',\tau_*}. \quad (367)$$

*By contrast, parametrizing  $\Gamma_{\text{pre}}$  and  $\Gamma_{\text{post}}$  independently by Choi matrices and then composing them introduces bilinear dependence on those two variables, so that parametrization is not itself a standard SDP representation of the general superchannel.*

A negative result at bounded  $d_E$  would not disprove Conjecture 1, which allows arbitrary finite ancilla dimension. A positive feasibility result for a small explicitly defined subclass, such as the single-channel sandwich construction of Proposition 15, would constitute genuine partial progress. Such a computation is distinct from the direct channel-evaluation scripts reported in Sec. XX. We have not carried it out and do not use any anticipated numerical outcome in support of the present claims.

**Remark 33** (Status of this section). We have not resolved the sufficiency direction of the conversion preorder on the calibration orbit. What is established here is: (i) the existing resource-value dilation (Proposition 16) already answers a strictly weaker question and should not be mistaken for orbit-restricted sufficiency; (ii) the most obvious candidate construction for the latter is provably not a valid quantum channel (Proposition 32); and (iii) the rigidity of Theorem 6 applies only to the unitary-congruence subclass and does not bear on the (much larger) space of candidate non-unitary or ancilla-assisted attenuators, so the sufficiency question remains genuinely open rather than closed by that theorem. This narrows the search considerably relative to the blank statement “the full ancilla-assisted preorder remains open” given in Sec. VI, without claiming a resolution.

### XVIII. BUFFERED LOCALITY OF COMPRESSED CHANNELS FOR GENUINELY COUPLED CHAINS

A genuinely coupled single-particle chain does not carry a canonical spatial tensor-product factorization: its Hilbert space is the direct sum  $\mathcal{H}_L = \bigoplus_n \langle n \rangle$ . Therefore the expression  $\rho_V \otimes \mathbb{1}_{\bar{V}}/d_{\bar{V}}$  and a spatial partial trace are not defined on the primary single-particle QRT object without an additional local tensor-product realization. The local reduction below is consequently stated as a separate conditional architecture. For the native single-particle setting, Proposition 28 is the unconditional local probe statement used in this paper.

**Definition 47** (Tensor-product local realization). A channel family admits a tensor-product local realization on a window decomposition if its underlying input and output Hilbert spaces are explicitly identified as

$$\boxed{\mathcal{K}_L = \mathcal{K}_V \otimes \mathcal{K}_{\bar{V}}.} \quad (368)$$

The local reduced channel construction below is asserted only for such realizations. No canonical tensor-product factorization is inferred from the single-particle spatial direct sum.

**Definition 48** (Reduced local channel). Let  $\mathcal{N}_L$  be a CPTP bistochastic channel in a tensor-product local realization and fix

$$\boxed{\sigma_{\bar{V}} = \frac{\mathbb{1}_{\bar{V}}}{d_{\bar{V}}}.} \quad (369)$$

Define

$$\boxed{\mathfrak{R}_V[\mathcal{N}_L](\rho_V) = \text{Tr}_{\bar{V}}[\mathcal{N}_L(\rho_V \otimes \sigma_{\bar{V}})]}. \quad (370)$$

For every fixed state  $\sigma_{\bar{V}}$  the map  $\rho_V \mapsto \mathfrak{R}_V[\mathcal{N}_L](\rho_V)$  is linear and CPTP, being the composition of the CPTP maps  $\rho_V \mapsto \rho_V \otimes \sigma_{\bar{V}}$ ,  $\mathcal{N}_L$ , and  $\text{Tr}_{\bar{V}}$ . For  $\sigma_{\bar{V}} = \mathbb{1}_{\bar{V}}/d_{\bar{V}}$  and unital  $\mathcal{N}_L$  it is also unital, hence bistochastic.

*Proof.* Linearity, complete positivity and trace preservation are inherited from the three factors. For unitality,

$$\mathfrak{R}_V[\mathcal{N}_L](\mathbb{1}_V) = \text{Tr}_{\bar{V}} \left[ \mathcal{N}_L \left( \frac{\mathbb{1}_V \otimes \mathbb{1}_{\bar{V}}}{d_{\bar{V}}} \right) \right] \quad (371)$$

$$= \text{Tr}_{\bar{V}} \left[ \frac{\mathbb{1}_V \otimes \mathbb{1}_{\bar{V}}}{d_{\bar{V}}} \right] = \mathbb{1}_V. \quad (372)$$

Trace preservation was noted above.  $\square$

**Remark 34** (Where the affine structure lives, and what is withdrawn). Definition 47 presumes a tensor-product local realization  $\mathcal{K}_L = \mathcal{K}_V \otimes \mathcal{K}_{\bar{V}}$ . A candidate is second quantization to the free-fermion Fock space  $\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{F}_V \otimes \mathcal{F}_{\bar{V}}$  of the Julia-dilated single-particle unitary. For a genuine many-body realization of this kind,  $\mathfrak{R}_V[\mathcal{N}_L]$  is, by Definition 48, an honest linear CPTP bistochastic map on density operators of  $\mathcal{F}_V$ . We have not constructed or analyzed this channel here; in particular we have not shown that its transpose equals the reduced channel of the second-quantized transposed Julia unitary, nor computed its diamond-norm asymmetry.

The affine structure occurs only in the single-particle correlation-matrix representation of Gaussian states, where  $C(t) = K C(0) K^\dagger$  and, for  $C(0) = C_V \oplus \mathbb{1}_{\bar{V}}/d_{\bar{V}}$ ,

$$C_V(t) = K_{VV} C_V K_{VV}^\dagger + \frac{1}{d_{\bar{V}}} K_{V\bar{V}} K_{V\bar{V}}^\dagger. \quad (373)$$

This is an affine map on Hermitian matrices, not a quantum channel on states, and  $A_\diamond$  is not defined for it. The offset  $\Xi_V := d_{\bar{V}}^{-1} K_{V\bar{V}} K_{V\bar{V}}^\dagger$  is thus a property of the covariance-matrix representation. It enters no monotonicity statement in this paper, and it depends explicitly on the complement dimension  $d_{\bar{V}}$  through its prefactor (see Sec. XX).

**Definition 49** (Buffered central window). Let  $V_j$  be a central interval of width  $\ell$ , and let  $W_j \supset V_j$  contain a buffer of thickness  $b$  on both sides. Assume the buffered windows are mutually disjoint. Let  $H_{W_j}$  denote the Hamiltonian restricted to  $W_j$  with couplings crossing the boundary of  $W_j$  removed. The isolated buffered channel is constructed using the same normalization gauge as the full channel comparison on the chosen operational interval. In particular, the comparison is required to use the same scalar normalization  $\kappa(t)$  for the full and restricted channels; an alternative discrepancy is absorbed into explicit buffer error constants below.

For a tensor-product local realization, the genuine reduced channel is

$$\mathcal{M}_{V_j}^{(L)} := \mathfrak{R}_{V_j}[\mathcal{N}_{H_L, t}], \quad (374)$$

and similarly, for the isolated buffered chain,

$$\mathcal{M}_{V_j}^{(W)} := \text{Tr}_{W_j \setminus V_j} \left[ \mathcal{N}_{H_{W_j}, t} \left( \rho \otimes \frac{\mathbb{1}_{W_j \setminus V_j}}{d_{W_j \setminus V_j}} \right) \right]. \quad (375)$$

These maps are honest linear CPTP bistochastic channels on the tensor-product local Hilbert space. We do not decompose them as  $\Lambda + \Xi$ .

For the separate single-particle covariance-matrix diagnostic, define

$$\Xi_{V_j}^{(L)} = \frac{1}{d_{V_j}} K_{V_j V_j}^{(L)} \left( K_{V_j V_j}^{(L)} \right)^\dagger, \quad (376)$$

and define  $\Xi_{V_j}^{(W)}$  analogously with the complement inside the isolated window. These offsets belong only to the covariance-matrix representation discussed in Remark 34. They are not components of the reduced channel  $\mathcal{M}_{V_j}^{(L)}$  or  $\mathcal{M}_{V_j}^{(W)}$ .

The symbol  $\Lambda_{V_j}$  is reserved below for the separately defined compressed-contraction Julia channel of Remark 35. No equality, decomposition, or approximation between  $\Lambda_{V_j}$  and the genuine reduced channel  $\mathcal{M}_{V_j}$  is assumed.

**Assumption 3** (Optional offset-buffer diagnostic). *Fix a compact operational time interval  $\mathcal{T}_0$  and a class of finite-range, uniformly bounded chains with a common strict-contraction bound  $\|K_{H_L, t}\|_\infty \leq q < 1$ . If one wishes to formulate a separate locality hypothesis for the covariance-matrix offset, assume that there are constants  $C_\Xi, \mu_\Xi > 0$ , independent of bulk position, system size, and  $t \in \mathcal{T}_0$ , such that*

$$\left\| \Xi_{V_j}^{(L)} - \Xi_{V_j}^{(W)} \right\|_\infty \leq C_\Xi e^{-\mu_\Xi b}. \quad (377)$$

*This assumption concerns only the covariance-matrix diagnostic  $\Xi_V$ . It is not used in any channel monotonicity statement or in Proposition 33. In particular, the numerical results of Sec. XX do not support an exponential estimate for the normalized offset in the form above.*

**Proposition 33** (Unconditional buffer estimate for the compressed-contraction channel). *Let  $H_L$  be bounded,  $\|H_L\|_\infty \leq h$ , and of range  $R$ . Let  $V$  be a window of width  $\ell$ ,  $W \supset V$  a window with buffer  $b > R$ , and  $H_W = P_W H_L P_W$  the restriction of  $H_L$  to  $W$ , extended by 0 outside  $W$ . Fix a compact operational-time interval  $\mathcal{T}_0 \subset [0, \infty)$  and assume that the full and buffered propagators use the same scalar normalization  $\kappa(t)$  with*

$$\|U_L(t)\|_\infty, \|U_W(t)\|_\infty \leq q\sqrt{\kappa(t)}, \quad q < 1, \quad (378)$$

*and with  $\inf_{t \in \mathcal{T}_0} \kappa(t) > 0$ . Then, for every fixed  $\mu > 0$ , there is a constant  $C_U = C_U(\ell, R, M, h, \mu, \mathcal{T}_0, \kappa)$  independent of  $L$  and of the position of  $V$  such that*

$$\left\| K_V^{(L)} - K_V^{(W)} \right\|_\infty \leq C_U e^{-\mu b}. \quad (379)$$

Consequently, with

$$C_\Lambda = 2 \left( 1 + \frac{q}{\sqrt{1-q^2}} \right) C_U, \quad (380)$$

one has

$$\left\| \Lambda_V^{(L)} - \Lambda_V^{(W)} \right\|_\diamond \leq C_\Lambda e^{-\mu b}, \quad (381)$$

and, by transpose invariance of the operator norm,

$$\left\| (\Lambda_V^{(L)})^{\text{rev}} - (\Lambda_V^{(W)})^{\text{rev}} \right\|_\diamond \leq C_\Lambda e^{-\mu b}. \quad (382)$$

*Proof.* Write the finite-range Hamiltonian as a sum of spatial displacement bands,

$$H_L = \sum_{r=-R}^R H_L^{(r)}. \quad (383)$$

Each band can be obtained by Fourier averaging of the on-site phase rotations generated by the position operator  $X$  and therefore obeys

$$\left\| H_L^{(r)} \right\|_\infty \leq \|H_L\|_\infty \leq h. \quad (384)$$

Consequently, the weighted Hamiltonian norms of Proposition 29 satisfy

$$J_\mu^\star \leq \sum_{r=-R}^R e^{\mu|r|} \left\| H_L^{(r)} \right\|_\infty \leq (2R+1)h e^{\mu R} =: \hat{J}_\mu, \quad (385)$$

which is independent of  $L$ .

Let

$$\Delta = H_L - (H_W \oplus 0). \quad (386)$$

Since  $H_W = P_W H_L P_W$ ,

$$\Delta P_W = (\mathbb{1} - P_W) H_L P_W, \quad \|\Delta P_W\|_\infty \leq h. \quad (387)$$

Moreover,  $\Delta P_W$  has support only on the  $R$  cells outside each boundary of  $W$ . Let  $Q$  be the projector onto those cells. Every matrix element connecting  $V$  to  $Q$  has separation at least  $b - R$ , so Proposition 29 gives, for  $0 \leq s \leq t$ ,

$$\left| (P_V U_L(t-s) Q)_{\alpha\beta} \right| \leq e^{-\mu(b-R) + \hat{J}_\mu t}. \quad (388)$$

The matrix  $P_V U_L(t-s) Q$  has dimensions  $(\ell M) \times (2RM)$ , and hence its Frobenius norm is bounded by

$$\|P_V U_L(t-s) Q\|_\infty \leq \|P_V U_L(t-s) Q\|_F \leq M\sqrt{2\ell R} e^{-\mu(b-R) + \hat{J}_\mu t}. \quad (389)$$

Duhamel's formula gives

$$P_V[U_L(t) - U_W(t)]P_V = -i \int_0^t P_V U_L(t-s) \Delta P_W U_W(s) P_V ds, \quad (390)$$

and  $\|U_W(s)\|_\infty \leq e^{hs}$ . Therefore

$$\|P_V[U_L(t) - U_W(t)]P_V\|_\infty \leq h t M \sqrt{2\ell R} e^{\mu R + (\hat{J}_\mu + h)t} e^{-\mu b}. \quad (391)$$

Dividing by  $\sqrt{\kappa(t)}$  yields

$$\|K_V^{(L)} - K_V^{(W)}\|_\infty \leq C_U(\ell, R, M, h, \mu, \mathcal{T}_0, \kappa) e^{-\mu b}, \quad (392)$$

with a constant uniform on  $\mathcal{T}_0$  because  $\kappa(t)$  is bounded away from zero there.

By the Lipschitz estimate used in Proposition 12,

$$\|\tilde{U}_{K_1} - \tilde{U}_{K_2}\|_\infty \leq \left(1 + \frac{q}{\sqrt{1-q^2}}\right) \|K_1 - K_2\|_\infty. \quad (393)$$

The same estimate holds after transpose because the operator norm is invariant under matrix transpose. Using

$$\|\mathcal{U}_1 - \mathcal{U}_2\|_\diamond \leq 2 \|U_1 - U_2\|_\infty \quad (394)$$

for unitary channels and the triangle inequality in the definition of  $A_\diamond$ , we obtain

$$\left|A_\diamond(\Lambda_V^{(L)}) - A_\diamond(\Lambda_V^{(W)})\right| \leq C(q) C_U e^{-\mu b}. \quad (395)$$

The rev-estimate follows by applying the same argument to the transposed contractions  $(K^{(L)})^T$  and  $(K^{(W)})^T$ .  $\square$

**Remark 35** (Meaning of  $\Lambda_V$  in this section: compressed-contraction channel). *From here on, and overriding any earlier phrase such as “linear (vacuum-background) part”,  $\Lambda_V$  denotes the following well-typed object. For a strict contraction  $K = K_{H,t}$  on  $\mathcal{H}_L$  and a window  $V$ , let  $K_V = P_V K P_V|_{\mathcal{H}_V}$  be its compression, so  $\|K_V\|_\infty \leq \|K\|_\infty \leq q < 1$ , and set*

$$\Lambda_V := \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{K_V} \quad (\text{canonical Julia completion of } K_V \text{ on } \mathcal{H}_V \oplus \mathcal{H}_V^{\text{en}}) \quad (396)$$

Since  $(K^T)_V = (K_V)^T$ , Corollary 1 gives  $\Lambda_V^{\text{rev}} = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{(K^T)_V}$ , and  $A_\diamond(\Lambda_V)$  is the ordinary channel asymmetry of a bistochastic unitary channel. The superscripts  $(L)$  and  $(W)$  refer to compression of  $K$  from the full chain and of  $K$  from the isolated buffered chain  $H_W$ , with the same scalar  $\kappa$ .

$\Lambda_V$  is a new channel on the window, associated with a truncation of the propagator. It is not shown here to be a piece, marginal, or bound for the reduced channel of a many-body tensor-product realization (Remark 34); that relation is open. The offset  $\Xi_V$  is a covariance-matrix diagnostic that appears in no  $A_\diamond$  statement.

**Corollary 10** (Buffered asymmetry bound for the compressed-contraction Julia channel). *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 33, for every  $t \in \mathcal{T}_0$ ,*

$$\left|A_\diamond(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)}) - A_\diamond(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(W)})\right| \leq C_\Lambda e^{-\mu b}. \quad (397)$$

*Proof.* By the triangle inequality,

$$|A_\diamond(\mathcal{A}) - A_\diamond(\mathcal{B})| \leq \frac{1}{2} (\|\mathcal{A} - \mathcal{B}\|_\diamond + \|\mathcal{A}^{\text{rev}} - \mathcal{B}^{\text{rev}}\|_\diamond). \quad (398)$$

Apply Proposition 33.  $\square$

**Remark 36** (Optional one-sided variant). *Because rev is a continuous involution on the finite-dimensional superoperator space, one may replace the second linear-part buffer estimate by a finite-dimensional norm bound*

$$\|\mathcal{A}^{\text{rev}} - \mathcal{B}^{\text{rev}}\|_\diamond \leq C_{\text{rev}}(d_V) \|\mathcal{A} - \mathcal{B}\|_\diamond \quad (399)$$

for fixed window dimension  $d_V$ . The two-sided formulation used in the main theorem is preferable because it is directly testable and avoids importing a non-intrinsic continuity constant.

**Remark 37** (How the buffer analysis is to be used). *The operational content of the coupled-chain extension is separated into two distinct objects. The exact QRT monotonicity applies to the compressed-contraction Julia channel  $\Lambda_V = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{P_V K P_V}$  defined in Remark 35. Its approximation by the isolated buffered-window channel is controlled by Proposition 33. Separately, the quantity  $\Xi_V$  belongs only to the single-particle covariance-matrix representation and is not a component of the reduced CPTP channel  $\mathfrak{R}_V[\mathcal{N}_L]$ . No relation between  $\Lambda_V$  and  $\mathfrak{R}_V[\mathcal{N}_L]$  is used or claimed in the present theorem.*

**Definition 50** (Local compressed-channel resource). *For disjoint windows  $V_1, \dots, V_J$ ,*

$$E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}(L, t) = \sum_{j=1}^J A_\diamond(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)}). \quad (400)$$

$$E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{iso}}(L, t) = \sum_{j=1}^J A_\diamond(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(W)}). \quad (401)$$

For the separate covariance-matrix diagnostic, define the aggregate offset sizes

$$\Xi_{\ell, b}^{\text{loc}}(L, t) = \sum_{j=1}^J \left\| \Xi_{V_j}^{(L)} \right\|_\infty, \quad \Xi_{\ell, b}^{\text{iso}}(L, t) = \sum_{j=1}^J \left\| \Xi_{V_j}^{(W)} \right\|_\infty. \quad (402)$$

These quantities are not identified with the channel resource  $E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}$ .

**Proposition 34** (Exact local monotonicity for compressed channels). *For each window  $V_j$ , let*

$$\Theta_j \in \mathfrak{D}(V_j) \quad (403)$$

denote a free superchannel defined by the same covariance-preserving construction as  $\mathfrak{D}_L$ , with the Hilbert-space dimension and reciprocity frame restricted to that window. Assume that the  $\Theta_j$  act independently on the compressed-contraction Julia channels  $\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)}$ . Then

$$\sum_{j=1}^J A_{\diamond}(\Theta_j(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)})) \leq E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}(L, t). \quad (404)$$

No robustness aggregate is introduced in this section.

*Proof.* Each  $\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)}$  is a bistochastic Julia-completed channel on the window, so Theorem 1 gives

$$A_{\diamond}(\Theta_j(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)})) \leq A_{\diamond}(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)}). \quad (405)$$

Summing over  $j$  yields the claim.  $\square$

**Proposition 35** (Exponential coupling control for compressed-contraction channels). *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 33 (in particular  $b > R$ ),*

$$|E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}(L, t) - E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{iso}}(L, t)| \leq J C(q) C e^{-\mu b}. \quad (406)$$

If fixed-width windows tile the bulk so that  $J = \Theta(L)$ , the discrepancy divided by  $L$  is  $O(e^{-\mu b})$ .

*Proof.* Sum the single-window estimate of Proposition 33 over  $j$  and use the triangle inequality. If  $J = \Theta(L)$ , division by  $L$  leaves the exponential dependence on  $b$  up to a constant prefactor.  $\square$

**Proposition 36** (Bulk local resource density). *Assume a fixed-width bulk tiling for which the number of windows satisfies*

$$\frac{J_L}{L} \longrightarrow \nu_{\ell} \quad (407)$$

as  $L \rightarrow \infty$ , with finite  $\nu_{\ell}$ . Define

$$a_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}(t) = \limsup_{L \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{L} E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}(L, t) \quad (408)$$

and

$$a_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{iso}}(t) = \limsup_{L \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{L} E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{iso}}(L, t). \quad (409)$$

Then both densities are finite for fixed  $\ell, t$ , and the unconditional buffer estimate gives

$$|a_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}(t) - a_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{iso}}(t)| \leq \nu_{\ell} C(q) C e^{-\mu b}. \quad (410)$$

No corresponding statement is made for the covariance-matrix offset.

*Proof.* Since  $0 \leq A_{\diamond} \leq 1$ ,

$$0 \leq \frac{1}{L} E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}(L, t) \leq \frac{J_L}{L}, \quad (411)$$

so the local density is finite under the assumed bounded tiling density. The same argument applies to the isolated-buffer benchmark. Proposition 35 gives

$$|E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}(L, t) - E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{iso}}(L, t)| \leq J_L C(q) C e^{-\mu b}. \quad (412)$$

Dividing by  $L$  and taking the limsup yields the stated bound.  $\square$

**Remark 38.** *These statements provide a controlled buffer analysis for coupled chains only when an explicit spatial tensor-product realization is supplied for any claim involving a genuine reduced channel. For the native single-particle Julia channel, the unconditional local probe is Proposition 28. The buffered theorem proved here concerns only the compressed contraction  $K_V = P_V K P_V$  and its Julia-completed channel  $\Lambda_V$ . The covariance-matrix offset  $\Xi_V$  is a separate representation-dependent diagnostic and is not part of the channel statement.*

## XIX. SYMMETRY-EXTENDED ARCHITECTURE

**Definition 51** (Covariance datum). *A covariance datum on  $\text{Obj}_L$  is a map  $r : \text{Obj}_L \rightarrow \text{Obj}_L$  satisfying*

1.  $r^2 = \text{id}$ ;
2.  $r$  is convex-linear;
3.  $r(\text{Obj}_L) \subseteq \text{Obj}_L$ ;
4.  $r$  acts cellwise on tensor-product arrays.

Transpose,  $r(\mathcal{N}) = \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}$ , is an example. Given a finite family  $\mathcal{G}$  of covariance data, a superchannel is called  $\mathcal{G}$ -covariant if

$$\Theta \circ r = r \circ \Theta \quad \forall r \in \mathcal{G}. \quad (413)$$

**Definition 52** (Symmetry-extended free set and asymmetry). *For a finite family  $\mathcal{G}$  of covariance data,*

$$\mathfrak{F}_{\mathcal{G}} = \bigcap_{r \in \mathcal{G}} \text{Fix}(r), \quad (414)$$

and

$$A_{\mathcal{G}}(\mathcal{N}) = \frac{1}{2} \max_{r \in \mathcal{G}} \|\mathcal{N} - r(\mathcal{N})\|_{\diamond}. \quad (415)$$

**Theorem 14** (Symmetry-extended monotonicity). *For every  $\mathcal{G}$ -free superchannel,*

$$A_{\mathcal{G}}(\Theta(\mathcal{N})) \leq A_{\mathcal{G}}(\mathcal{N}). \quad (416)$$

and

$$A_{\mathcal{G}}(\mathcal{N}) = 0 \iff \mathcal{N} \in \mathfrak{F}_{\mathcal{G}}. \quad (417)$$

On a cellular array,

$$E_{\mathcal{G}}(\mathcal{N}) = \sum_k A_{\mathcal{G}}(\mathcal{N}_k) \quad (418)$$

is monotone under symmetry-covariant cellwise free superchannels.

*Proof.* Let  $r^*$  attain the maximum in  $A_{\mathcal{G}}(\Theta(\mathcal{N}))$ . Covariance gives  $r^*\Theta = \Theta r^*$ , so

$$A_{\mathcal{G}}(\Theta(\mathcal{N})) = \frac{1}{2} \|\Theta(\mathcal{N}) - \Theta(r^*(\mathcal{N}))\|_{\diamond} \quad (419)$$

$$\leq \frac{1}{2} \|\mathcal{N} - r^*(\mathcal{N})\|_{\diamond} \quad (420)$$

$$\leq A_{\mathcal{G}}(\mathcal{N}). \quad (421)$$

Faithfulness follows from the finite maximum.  $\square$

**Remark 39.** *The present paper uses the single covariance datum  $\mathcal{G} = \{\text{rev}\}$ . A different NHSE sector can be incorporated only after its physical symmetry action has been explicitly defined and shown to satisfy the covariance axioms. In particular, no reciprocal non-Abelian  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  skin resource or Lindbladian skin resource is claimed to have been constructed here.*

#### A. Postselection versus genuinely open quantum dynamics

The present CPTP embedding is a completion of a normalized non-Hermitian propagation operator. It is not a claim of equivalence with arbitrary gain/loss Lindblad dynamics. A genuinely open system resource theory would require an enlarged object class, for example CPTP dynamical maps or Lindbladian generators, with its own free operations. This distinction is substantive: recent work has shown that Lindbladian skin topology can retain information that is invisible in postselected non-Hermitian Hamiltonian descriptions [14].

## XX. NUMERICAL CHECKS AND REPRODUCIBILITY STATUS

The two-site calibration is fully analytic and can be checked directly from the four-by-four Julia unitary. No numerical data are needed for the central ordering and rigidity theorems. In particular, for

$$W_g = \tilde{U}_{K_g}^\dagger \tilde{U}_{K_g}^T, \quad (422)$$

the eigenphases determine

$$A_{\diamond} = \sqrt{1 - c(g)^2}. \quad (423)$$

Beyond the analytic calibration, three numerical checks are reported. They should be understood as consistency checks of the analytic statements rather than as independent proofs.

**Numerical check of Lemma 1.** At  $L = 60$  and fixed  $t$ , the propagator and normalized contraction give the same fitted rate,  $\mu(U_H(t)) = \mu(K) \approx 2.5648$  over the short range before reaching double-precision noise. For the defect operators, the quoted fit on  $r \in [2, 25]$  gives  $\mu(D_K) = \mu(D_{K^\dagger}) \approx 0.6625$ , while refitting over the full available range gives approximately 0.5938. The visible dependence on the fit window is therefore non-negligible, and the numerical data should not be used to claim a unique precision exponent for the defect operators. The robust numerical conclusion is qualitative: the defect operators are exponentially decaying over the tested range but display a slower and more fit-sensitive decay than  $K$  itself.

**Finite- $t$  probe bound of Proposition 28 versus  $L$ .** For the uniform Hatano–Nelson family at fixed  $g \neq 0$  and the tight gauge of Remark 25, the concrete finite-size lower-bound expression was evaluated for  $L = 4, 8, 12, 20, 30, 45, 60, 90, 120$ . The reported values decrease from approximately 0.1376 at  $L = 4$  to 0.122676 at  $L = 120$ . This numerical sequence is consistent with the analytic  $L$ -uniform short-time estimate. The decrease is, however, entirely due to the  $L$ -dependent tight normalization  $\kappa_L$  (from 1.98 to 2.286): the product  $\kappa_L \times (\text{bound})$  is 0.2726 at  $L = 4$  and constant, 0.2805, for all tested  $L \geq 8$ . A test that isolates locality should therefore use one fixed  $L$ -independent  $\kappa$ ; with  $\kappa = 2.2865$  the finite-size bound rises from 0.1192 ( $L = 4$ ) to 0.12265 ( $L = 8$ ) and is constant to six digits for  $L \geq 12$ , within 3% of the leading short-time value  $t^2 D_{\text{amp}}/(2\kappa) = 0.1259$ . The reported sequence is not a proof of the thermodynamic bound.

**Compressed-contraction buffer test (Sec. XVIII).** For  $\ell = 4$ , bulk  $L = 60$ , and a common normalization inferred from the bulk propagator norm, the script evaluates the asymmetry of the compressed-contraction Julia channel  $\Lambda_V = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{K_V}$  for the full chain and for isolated buffered windows. This is a test of Proposition 33, not of a many-body reduced channel. The bulk value is  $A_{\diamond}(\Lambda_V^{(L)}) = 0.528469$ , and the isolated-window value agrees to the displayed precision from  $b = 2$  onward. No decay rate is fitted or claimed: only a few points lie above double-precision noise, so any fitted exponent would depend on the fitting window. The data are used only to show rapid convergence to the numerical floor, consistent with the analytic exponential buffer bound.

Two offset diagnostics must be distinguished. (i) The *normalized* offset  $\Xi = d_V^{-1} K_{V^\dagger} K_V^\dagger$  uses different maximally-mixed complement dimensions in the full chain and the window,  $d_V = 56$  and  $d_{V^\dagger} = 2b$ . Its discrepancy,  $\|\Xi^{(L)} - \Xi^{(W)}\| \approx 0.070, 0.035, 0.023, 0.016, 0.013, 0.010, 0.0068, 0.0049$  for

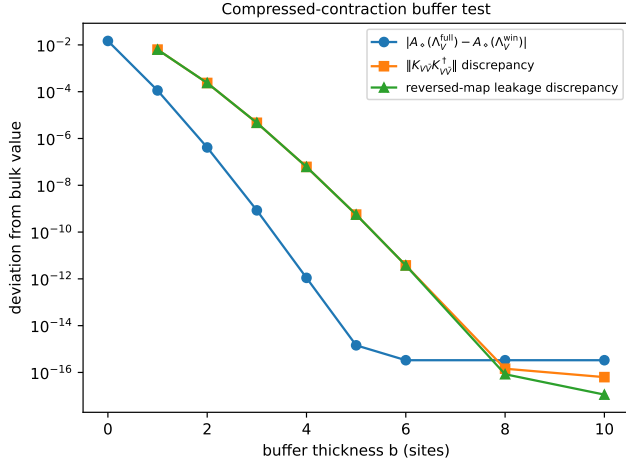


FIG. 3. Buffered convergence of the compressed-contraction Julia channel  $\Lambda_V = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{P_V K P_V}$  for  $\ell = 4$  and bulk  $L = 60$ . The asymmetry discrepancy  $|A_\diamond(\Lambda_V^{(L)}) - A_\diamond(\Lambda_V^{(W)})|$  falls to the numerical floor rapidly; because the fitted exponent depends strongly on the fitting range, no precision value of  $\mu_\Lambda$  is claimed. The plotted offset curves are the un-normalized leakage  $K_{V\bar{V}}K_{V\bar{V}}^\dagger$  (full chain versus window), which also converges rapidly, faster than a single exponential; no fitted rate is claimed. The normalized offset  $\Xi$ , which carries the prefactor  $1/d_{\bar{V}}$  and is not plotted, instead decays as approximately  $1/b$  because of the complement-dimension mismatch (see text). The figure concerns the compressed-contraction channel and the separate covariance diagnostic; it is not a test of a genuine many-body reduced channel.

$b = 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10$ , satisfies

$$b \|\Xi^{(L)} - \Xi^{(W)}\| \in [0.049, 0.071],$$

i.e. approximately  $1/b$  decay, which is dominated by the prefactor mismatch rather than by nonlocality of the propagator; no exponential fit is quoted for it. (ii) The *un-normalized* leakage  $K_{V\bar{V}}K_{V\bar{V}}^\dagger$ , which is the quantity plotted in Fig. 3 (script default `normalize=False`), was tested at the same parameter point: the discrepancy between full chain and window is  $6.3 \times 10^{-3}$ ,  $2.4 \times 10^{-4}$ ,  $\approx 5 \times 10^{-6}$  for  $b = 1, \dots, 6$  (the earlier six-decimal printout is superseded):  $6.3 \times 10^{-3}$ ,  $2.4 \times 10^{-4}$ ,  $4.7 \times 10^{-6}$ ,  $6.1 \times 10^{-8}$ ,  $5.6 \times 10^{-10}$ ,  $3.8 \times 10^{-12}$ ; for  $b \geq 8$  the discrepancy is  $\lesssim 10^{-16}$ , i.e. double-precision noise. The successive ratios of the first five values ( $\approx 27, 50, 77, 110$ ) increase with  $b$ , i.e. the decay is faster than any single exponential, as expected from the factorial (Poisson) tail of the propagator. The  $1/b$  behavior of  $\Xi$  is therefore a normalization artifact. No decay rate is quoted for either curve, and neither offset enters any channel statement. The numerical study uses the single parameter point  $(g, t, \ell, L) = (0.5, 0.35, 4, 60)$ .

## XXI. UNIFIED RESOURCE ARCHITECTURE

The logical structure is

|                                        |                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| fixed-time QRT                         | : $(\text{Obj}_L, \mathfrak{F}_L, \mathfrak{D}_L, \succeq_{\mathfrak{D}}, A_\diamond, R_{\text{rob}})$ ,   |
| thermodynamic QRT layer                | : $(\{\text{Obj}_L\}_{L \geq 1}, \mathfrak{D}_\infty, A_{\diamond, \infty}, R_{\text{rob}, \infty})$ ,     |
| explicit rigid subclass                | : $(\mathfrak{D}_{\text{uc}}, \chi_{\text{cs}})$ ,                                                         |
| trajectory-derived extension           | : $(A_\diamond^{\text{sup}}, R_{\text{rob}}^{\text{sup}})$ ,                                               |
| trajectory-level free maps             | : $(f = \{\Theta_t\}_{t \in \mathcal{T}})$ ,                                                               |
| cellular extensive extension           | : $(\mathfrak{D}_{\text{loc}}, E_\diamond, E_{\text{rob}})$ ,                                              |
| trajectory-derived extensive extension | : $(E_\diamond^{\text{sup}}, E_{\text{rob}}^{\text{sup}})$ ,                                               |
| tensor-local coupled-chain extension   | : $(E_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}, a_{\diamond, \ell, b}^{\text{loc}}, \Xi_{\ell, b}^{\text{loc}})$ , |
| symmetry extension                     | : $(\mathcal{G}, \mathfrak{F}_{\mathcal{G}}, A_{\mathcal{G}})$ ,                                           |
| spectral diagnostics                   | : $(\beta, \rho_{\text{GBZ}}, W)$ ,                                                                        |
| disorder diagnostics                   | : $(\gamma, R_{\text{Lyp}}^{\text{skin}})$ ,                                                               |
| spatial/dynamical diagnostics          | : $(C_I^{L/R}, G_I; P_t, D_t)$ .                                                                           |

(424)

The exact logical implications are

$$H^T = H \implies \begin{cases} \mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{N}_{H,t}, \\ W_{\text{BZ}} = 0, \\ \beta \leftrightarrow \beta^{-1}, \\ \gamma_j = -\gamma_{2M+1-j}, \end{cases} \quad (425)$$

while

$$\mathcal{N} \succeq_{\mathfrak{D}} \mathcal{M} \implies A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}) \geq A_\diamond(\mathcal{M}), \quad R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{N}) \geq R_{\text{rob}}(\mathcal{M}). \quad (426)$$

For a cellular array,

$$\Theta \in \mathfrak{D}_{\text{loc}} \implies E_\diamond(\Theta(\mathcal{N})) \leq E_\diamond(\mathcal{N}), \quad (427)$$

and at the trajectory-derived level,

$$E_\diamond^{\text{sup}}(\mathfrak{f}\mathfrak{N}) \leq E_\diamond^{\text{sup}}(\mathfrak{N}). \quad (428)$$

For genuinely coupled chains, the correct local statement in the present paper is on the separately defined compressed-contraction Julia channels  $\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)} = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{P_{V_j} K P_{V_j}}$ ,

$$\sum_j A_\diamond(\Theta_j(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)})) \leq \sum_j A_\diamond(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)}), \quad (429)$$

together with the unconditional buffer estimate

$$|A_\diamond(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(L)}) - A_\diamond(\Lambda_{V_j}^{(W)})| \leq C_\Lambda e^{-\mu b} \quad (430)$$

with  $C_\Lambda, \mu$  as in Proposition 33. The covariance-matrix offset  $\Xi_{V_j}$  carries no buffer estimate in this paper: Assumption 3 is an optional, unverified hypothesis, and the normalized offset is observed numerically to decay only as  $1/b$ . For the native single-particle direct-sum Hilbert space, the unconditional local probe is Proposition 28, not a partial-trace reduction.

On the uniform Hatano–Nelson orbit,

$$\begin{aligned} A_\diamond^{\text{sup}}(H_g) > 0 &\iff g \neq 0 \\ \iff \rho_{\text{GBZ}} > 0 &\iff \text{conventional OBC NHSE}, \end{aligned} \quad (431)$$

with the NHSE statement understood for the thermodynamic uniform chain family. The full ancilla-assisted conversion problem remains distinct from this witness equivalence.

## XXII. SCOPE AND LIMITATIONS

The primitive theory is finite-time and operational. At fixed finite  $L$ , its objects are the CPTP bistochastic channels on the doubled Hilbert space; the finite- $L$  exponential locality notation is a compatibility structure, while non-trivial locality enters through  $L$ -uniform thermodynamic family conditions. The free channels are transpose reciprocal, and the free operations are covariance-constrained quantum superchannels that preserve the object class. We interpret this covariance condition as the axiomatic symmetry-free choice of the present QRT rather than as a complete microscopic model of engineering cost. Covariance is imposed on the stated object class; no stronger covariance on a larger space is silently assumed. The Julia dilation is a canonical representation choice for the normalized propagator, not a uniqueness theorem for physical dilations. The only no-ancilla rigidity statement proved here uses the explicitly defined unitary-congruence subclass  $\mathfrak{D}_{\text{uc}}(L)$ .

Several clarifications are central.

First, the finite-size quasi-locality definition is deliberately separated from the thermodynamic locality layer. The fixed- $L$  object class is suitable for finite-dimensional QRT statements, while thermodynamic claims use sequences with  $L$ -uniform locality constants and superchannels with the locality certificate of Definition 15. Thus finite-dimensional global maps are not silently treated as thermodynamically local.

Second, channel transpose is a linear involution but an anti-homomorphism under composition:

$$(\mathcal{A} \circ \mathcal{B})^{\text{rev}} = \mathcal{B}^{\text{rev}} \circ \mathcal{A}^{\text{rev}}. \quad (432)$$

For this reason the reciprocity-covariance condition belongs to the complete superchannel. The main monotonicity theorems never use transpose as a diamond-norm isometry.

Third, the calibration family is ordered exactly by the monotone  $A_{\diamond}$ :

$$|g| \geq |g'| \iff A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_{g,\tau_*}) \geq A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_{g',\tau_*}). \quad (433)$$

This proves the necessary condition  $|g| \geq |g'|$  for free conversion, and rules out deterministic gauge amplification. It does not establish deterministic attenuation in the full ancilla-assisted superchannel class. The ancilla-free unitary covariant subclass is rigid by the cosquare invariant. A full sufficiency theorem requires an explicit deterministic attenuation protocol.

Fourth, normalization dependence has been separated from the symmetry question. The condition  $A_{\diamond} = 0$  is invariant under every finite strict scalar normalization, while the numerical value can change and can even be driven to zero by taking the normalization arbitrarily large. The quantitative normalization-equivalence theorem controls this dependence only inside a common strict-contraction ball. The trajectory-derived tight gauge removes the separate overall energy- rescaling ambiguity when the full positive-time domain is optimized.

Fifth, the exact generalization to NHSE is intentionally class based. Theorem 7 is a theorem about transpose-reciprocity breaking. A converse with conventional NHSE is available only on model classes in which conventional NHSE is itself equivalent to transpose-reciprocity breaking. The uniform Hatano–Nelson gauge orbit is the primary exact example. Reciprocal non-Abelian  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  skin physics is explicitly outside this sector.

Sixth, the fixed-time global monotones are bounded by one, so their tensor-power rates vanish. Extensivity requires either the explicit tensor-product cellular construction with cellwise local operations or the local-channel construction for coupled systems, the latter only under an additional tensor-product local realization.

Seventh, a direct-sum single-particle Hilbert space does not possess a canonical spatial tensor product. Therefore the buffered reduction is conditional: it assumes an independently supplied tensor-product local realization if one wishes to speak of a many-body reduced channel; the buffer estimates proved here (Proposition 33) concern only the compressed contraction  $P_V K P_V$  and its transpose. No partial trace over a single-particle spatial complement is taken.

Eighth, the coupled-chain buffer comparison is normalization-consistent by construction: the same scalar normalization is used for the full and isolated buffered channels, unless a separate normalization-discrepancy estimate is included in the explicit error constants. This prevents an unnoticed change of normalization gauge from being misidentified as a locality effect.

Ninth, the exact closed form of

$$A_{\diamond}^{\text{sup}}(H) = \sup_{t>0} A_{\diamond}(\mathcal{N}_{H,t}^{\text{tight}}) \quad (434)$$

beyond the two-site calibration and thermodynamic lower bound remains unresolved. The full ancilla-assisted covariant superchannel classification also remains open.

Tenth, the cellular extensive extension is an operational tensor-product construction. It is not asserted to equal the canonical Julia channel of a globally normalized single-particle direct-sum Hamiltonian. This distinction is essential because the scalar normalization and Julia defect operators generally do not factorize under a global normalization.

Eleventh, the reduced channel  $\mathfrak{R}_V[\mathcal{N}_L]$  of Definition 48 is, for any tensor-product realization, a linear CPTP bistochastic map on density operators; the affine offset  $\Xi_V$  occurs only in the single-particle covariance-matrix representation of Gaussian states (Remark 34) and is not a property of that channel. The buffered analysis of Sec. XVIII is carried out on a different object: the Julia completion  $\Lambda_V = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{K_V}$  of the compressed contraction  $K_V = P_V K P_V$  (Remark 35), whose buffer convergence is an unconditional consequence of propagator quasi-locality (Proposition 33). We have not established any relation—equality, inequality, or approximation—between  $\Lambda_V$  and the reduced channel of a second-quantized (many-body) realization, nor computed the latter’s diamond-norm asymmetry. This

relation is the actual open problem of the coupled-chain extension. Numerically, only  $\Lambda_V$  was tested, at a single parameter point (Sec. XX); the covariance-matrix offset was found to decay as  $1/b$  owing to a mismatched normalization and no exponential buffer convergence is claimed for it.

Finally, the present theory deliberately excludes genuinely Lindbladian resource objects. This is not a technicality: recent work distinguishes Lindbladian skin topology from postselected non-Hermitian Hamiltonian topology [14]. Likewise, reciprocal non-Abelian  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  skin physics lies outside the transpose-reciprocity-breaking sector; a recent 2026 PRL provides an explicit reciprocal non-Abelian mechanism [13].

### XXIII. CONCLUSION

We constructed a fixed-time quantum-channel resource theory for the transpose-reciprocity-breaking sector associated with conventional NHSE, with quasi-local CPTP bistochastic objects, reciprocal free channels, covariance-constrained free superchannels, and faithful monotones  $A_\diamond$  and  $R_{\text{rob}}$ .

The Julia completion provides a canonical CPTP operational representation of normalized non-Hermitian propagation. The bistochastic object restriction closes the channel transpose operation, so the free set is mathematically well typed. The general Julia transpose identities are

$$D_K^T = D_{K^*}, \quad D_{K^\dagger}^T = D_{K^T}, \quad (435)$$

which give

$$\tilde{U}_K^T = \tilde{U}_{K^T}. \quad (436)$$

The canonical Julia choice is treated as a representation convention rather than as a uniqueness claim about all physical dilations.

The asymmetry has a direct operational meaning:

$$A_\diamond(\mathcal{N}) = 2p_{\text{succ}}^{\text{opt}}(\mathcal{N}, \mathcal{N}^{\text{rev}}) - 1. \quad (437)$$

Thus the resource is exactly twice the optimal one-shot advantage over random guessing when detecting whether a channel and its reciprocal transpose are being presented.

On the two-site Hatano–Nelson calibration, the exact channel asymmetry is strictly increasing in  $|g|$  under a common strict normalization. Therefore the scalar parameter  $|g|$  is exactly ordered by  $A_\diamond$  on that calibration orbit, and every deterministic free conversion obeys the necessary condition  $|g| \geq |g'|$ . The stronger biconditional conversion law is not claimed because deterministic attenuation in the full ancilla-assisted class requires an explicit protocol. Within the explicitly defined ancilla-free unitary-congruence subclass, the phase-invariant cosquare scalar  $\chi_{\text{cs}}$  makes  $|g|$  rigid.

The normalization convention is treated as an operational gauge. Within the strict scalar class, the resource support is normalization independent, while quantitative values are controlled by an explicit continuity bound. Under the per-Hamiltonian tight gauge and full positive-time optimization,

$$A_\diamond^{\text{sup}}(\lambda H) = A_\diamond^{\text{sup}}(H). \quad (438)$$

The trajectory-derived extension is a pointwise derived construction: fixed-time monotonicity holds at each  $t$ , and taking the supremum yields monotonicity under families of pointwise free superchannels. This construction is not claimed to be a causal process-supermap resource theory.

The thermodynamic short-time theorem uses an explicitly  $L$ -uniform propagator remainder and an  $L$ -uniform transition-intensity estimate, whose numerator is numerically constant in system size (Sec. XX). For the uniform Hatano–Nelson family this yields

$$\liminf_{t \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{A_{\diamond, \infty}(t)}{t^2} \geq \frac{2J^2 \sinh(2|g|)}{1 + \varepsilon_0} > 0 \quad (g \neq 0), \quad (439)$$

so the thermodynamic resource persistence is not a finite-size artifact at the level proved here.

The exact logical content of the NHSE correspondence is now separated into three layers. First, for finite-dimensional Hamiltonians with a time domain accumulating at zero,

$$A_{\diamond, \kappa}^{\text{sup}} > 0 \iff H^T \neq H. \quad (440)$$

Second, transpose-reciprocity-breaking conventional NHSE necessarily carries positive channel resource. Third, on transpose-reciprocity-complete model classes, conventional NHSE is exactly characterized by positivity of the trajectory-derived resource. The uniform Hatano–Nelson family is the principal exact example:

$$A_\diamond^{\text{sup}}(H_g) > 0 \iff g \neq 0 \iff \rho_{\text{GBZ}} > 0 \iff \text{conventional OBC} \quad (441)$$

The cellular extension gives an exactly additive extensive resource under an explicitly defined tensor-product laboratory architecture. For genuinely coupled systems, the present buffered theorem concerns only the compressed-contraction Julia channel  $\Lambda_V = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{P_V K P_V}$ . Its asymmetry obeys an unconditional exponential buffer estimate derived from propagator locality (Proposition 33). This result does not identify  $\Lambda_V$  with the reduced channel of a many-body tensor-product realization, nor does it provide such a reduced-channel approximation theorem. The covariance-matrix offset remains a separate representation-dependent diagnostic.

Spectral, disorder, spatial, and dynamical quantities remain diagnostics rather than axioms of the QRT. Clean reciprocity forces zero determinant winding and reciprocal roots; reciprocal disordered chains have Lyapunov pairing; and the  $g \oplus (-g)$  construction demonstrates that scalar

winding can cancel while the channel resource remains positive.

The resulting architecture is therefore a genuine channel QRT for transpose-reciprocity breaking, supplemented by a trajectory-derived extension, an explicitly tensor-product extensive theory, and a compressed-contraction buffer analysis for coupled chains whose relation to a many-body reduced channel is explicitly left open. It is not a universal resource theory for the physical non-Hermitian skin effect, and we deliberately resist framing it as one: outside the uniform Hatano–Nelson calibration, the correspondence with conventional NHSE is one-directional (Corollary 5) or conditional on an explicitly stated completeness property of the model class (Definition 31). Three concrete gaps remain, in decreasing order of how fundamental we judge them to be. First, the numerical value of every monotone constructed here depends on an operator-chosen scalar normalization gauge (Proposition 13); only the resource *support*  $A_\diamond = 0$  vs.  $> 0$  is gauge invariant, and a gauge-free quantitative resource measure is not constructed. Second, only a necessary condition ( $|g| \geq |g'|$ ) and a no-go rigidity result (Theorem 6)

are established for conversion on the calibration orbit; no sufficiency direction or explicit deterministic attenuation protocol is given for the full ancilla-assisted free-operation class. Third, the coupled-chain local analysis of Sec. XVIII is not closed: it is proved for the compressed-contraction channel  $\Lambda_V = \tilde{\mathcal{E}}_{P_V K P_V}$ , but no relation is established between  $\Lambda_V$  and the reduced channel of a second-quantized tensor-product realization of the chain, so a local resource statement for the many-body reduced channel is left as an explicit open problem. Extending the architecture to reciprocal non-Abelian  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  skin physics or to genuinely Lindbladian skin topology would additionally require identifying the corresponding physical covariance data and enlarging the primitive object class.

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